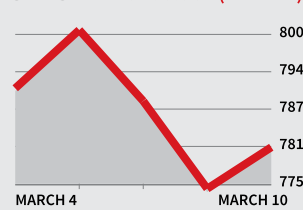


the hindu businessline

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	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24261.60	+233.55
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.47	+0.18
US Dollar (in ₹)	91.80	-0.52
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	159547.00	+1508
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	270944.00	+10888

BOUNTIFUL HARVEST.

Foodgrain output for 2025-26 is seen 3% up at 349 mt on higher production of wheat, maize and mustard crops **p10**



AMFI DATA.

Mutual fund equity inflows rise 8% in February to ₹25,978 crore; flexi and mid-caps lead **p6**

Centre secures 1 mt LPG from US to bridge W. Asia supply gap

SAFETY NET. Tells refiners to maximise gas output; invokes Essential Commodities Act

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



SUPPLY PLANNING. The LPG deficit was about 40 very large gas carriers, of which supply of around 20 has been arranged

The government has arranged around one million tonnes (mt) of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) cargoes, mostly from the US, to meet the demand for the key cooking fuel used by more than 330 million consumers. The proactive measure accompanied top-level discussions between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and senior Cabinet Ministers, including Nirmala Sitharaman (Finance), Hardeep Singh Puri (Petroleum), Piyush Goyal (Commerce) and S Jaishankar (External Affairs). The Prime Minister reportedly asked the Ministers to co-ordinate and ensure that consumers do not suffer from the impact of the West Asia conflict on the supply and price of petroleum products, especially LPG, sources said.

IMPORT DEPENDENCE India burnt over 33 mt of LPG in FY25, with more than half of the demand met through imports. West Asia

accounted for nearly 90 per cent of India's LPG imports, which stood at 20.67 mt. Besides, it produced 12.79 mt during the year. Regular supplies of LPG are important for India as the country does not have strategic reserves for the cooking fuel. "The LPG situation is getting more comfortable as production is being ramped up. Besides, we have been out in the market sourcing as much as we can," said a top government source.

SECURING SUPPLIES India has also been seeking to step up imports from the US and Canada. Another

source said the LPG deficit was around 40 very large gas carriers (VLGCs), of which arrangements had been made for roughly 20 VLGCs. The cargoes are expected to arrive at Indian ports from the month-end. A single VLGC can carry up to 50,000 tonnes of LPG. A back-of-the-envelope calculation shows that the LPG deficit was around 2 mt, of which cargoes for roughly 1 mt have been arranged. Anticipating a disruption in domestic LPG supply, the government has been prioritising production of the gas. For instance, India invoked emergency powers last

week, directing refiners to maximise production of the critical cooking fuel. Based on data from the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC), India's average per day production of LPG stood around 34,613 tonnes in October 2025, which dipped to 34,533 tonnes in November. However, the output rose to 35,968 tonnes in December 2025 and further to 37,355 tonnes in January 2026; February numbers are yet to be published. For the entire calendar 2025, India's daily average LPG production stood around 38,099 tonnes.

SUPPLY REGULATION India also invoked the Essential Commodities Act late on Monday to regulate natural gas supply. The order prioritises the supply of natural gas to domestic piped natural gas supply (D-PNG), compressed natural gas (CNG) for transport and LPG production, as well as pipeline compressor fuel and other essential pipeline operational requirements.

Also read **p2, p3**

IndiGo CEO Elbers resigns; Rahul Bhatia to take interim charge

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Airline major InterGlobe Aviation, the parent of IndiGo, on Tuesday said its Chief Executive Officer Pieter Elbers has resigned with immediate effect. Elbers, a former CEO of KLM Royal Dutch Airlines, had taken over at IndiGo in September 2022, succeeding Ronojoy Dutta. Elbers oversaw the airline's international expansion, the roll-out of premium products, placing large orders for jets and the induction of leased wide-body 787 aircraft as the carrier entered its next phase of growth. His departure comes months after the airline faced widespread flight disruptions and cancellations that left thousands of passengers stranded and drew regulatory scrutiny. The Directorate General of Civil Aviation had issued a caution to Elbers for inadequate overall oversight of flight operations and crisis management. Managing Director and Co-founder Rahul Bhatia will assume interim management of the airline until a new CEO is appointed.

Read More on **p14**

To stabilise ₹, RBI may use 2013 plan to help banks mop up NRI \$ deposits

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai



The rupee has depreciated about 7.4% to ₹91.81 per \$ as of Tuesday from 85.49 as of March-end 2025 **REUTERS**

The Reserve Bank of India may look to revive a strategy it last employed in 2013 to attract dollars into the country via the Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Banks) and Non-Resident External deposit routes. This could help stabilise the rupee, which is facing headwinds due to the heat of the West Asia conflict. Exempting the two categories of NRI deposits from statutory pre-emptions — cash reserve ratio (CRR) and statutory liquidity ratio (SLR) — and the RBI opening a special window for banks to swap fresh, long-tenor FCNR(B) dollar funds at a fixed rate could be two options for the central bank to break the fall in the rupee and bolster its ability to intervene in the market, say experts.

RUPEE PRESSURE The rupee depreciated about 7.4 per cent to ₹91.81 per dollar as of Tuesday from 85.49 as of end-March 2025 amid a widening merchandise trade deficit, including due to the US slapping steep tariffs on Indian goods, and foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) selling in the do-

FCNR(B) deposits by providing them with a temporary exemption from maintaining the statutory reserve ratios. K Arvind, Executive Vice-President (Head-Treasury), Tamilnad Mercantile Bank, said that if the RBI offers banks a window to swap fresh FCNR(B) dollar funds, it will be beneficial to all stakeholders. The RBI's ability to defend the domestic currency due to the swap will be further bolstered. Additionally, it will generate rupee liquidity for the banking system, and NRIs will get better returns. He noted there will be an element of uncertainty about the future in the minds of NRIs due to the global ramifications of the West Asia conflict. So, they may channelise their overseas savings/investments into NR deposits with Indian banks. In the first nine months of FY26, overall NR deposit inflows were about 16 per cent lower at \$11.204 billion against \$13.333 billion in the year ago period, per RBI data. Within this, FCNR(B) deposit accretion was down 68 per cent y-o-y at \$2.042 billion. However, NRE and NRO deposits were up 42 per cent (at \$5.065 billion) and 24 per cent (\$4.097 billion), respectively.

Restaurants across country trim menus, cut 'serving times' singed by a severe shortage of cooking gas

Our Bureaus
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Mumbai/ Bengaluru



KITCHEN IMPACT. A worker carries LPG cylinders inside a restaurant in Bengaluru. Hotels in the city expressed concerns over the shortage of LPG cylinders **p11**

The West Asia conflict has caused a shortage of commercial LPG, disrupting operations at restaurants and hotels nationwide. Businesses are shrinking menus and hours as the industry calls for urgent government intervention on cooking gas supplies. Federation of Hotel & Restaurant Associations of India Vice-President Pradeep Shetty warned that severe LPG shortages were being seen across major cities and States. With no viable alternatives, the industry urgently needs supplies restored to avert widespread shutdowns. Shetty said severe shortages were being reported in Maharashtra, specifically in Mumbai, where nearly 50 per cent of hotels and restaurants are fearing temporary closure if the situation does not im-

prove in the next two days. Disruptions have also been reported in Pune and Aurangabad, as well as in States such as Karnataka, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. **'ESSENTIAL SUPPLY'** Pranav Rungta, Vice-President, National Restaurant Association of India (NRAI), said the effort is to get the authorities to recognise the restaurant industry as "essential supply." This is an unprecedented crisis for the industry that generates ₹2,000 crore

daily, he said. On Tuesday, an NRAI advisory outlined various suggestions for members, ranging from rationalising menus to introducing limited "crisis menus" with fast-cooking items and limiting operations to peak hours. **MENU CUTS** For instance, Coimbatore's Annapoorna Hotels is restricting its iconic all-day dosas to breakfast and dinner as LPG stocks thin and new bookings are halted. "We have limited stocks and we have re-

duced our menu offerings and also the availability timings," said a hotel employee. The hotel said that from Wednesday, they will also be trimming their offerings on Swiggy and Zomato. "High-gas items like dosa and poori are leaving the menu in favour of idli and sandwiches," said a Chennai-based restaurant owner. Sharda Bhavan in Matunga, Mumbai, has stopped serving 'onion uttapam' and 'rava dosa' as these take longer to cook. "We have almost run out of gas and will use electric induction stoves," said owner Ganesh Rao. The Telangana Gig and Platform Workers' Union and the Indian Federation of App-Based Transport Workers cautioned that disruptions in LPG and CNG supplies could affect drivers and delivery workers dependent on platforms like Swiggy, Zomato, Uber and Rapido for their daily income.

Norms eased to attract more FDI from China, neighbours in key sectors

Amity Sen
New Delhi

India eased the foreign direct investment (FDI) norms for entities based in land-bordering countries (LBCs), including China, in a move aimed at attracting more investments into key manufacturing sectors, such as electronic components, capital goods and solar cells. The revised policy, approved by the Union Cabinet on Tuesday, introduces a clearer definition of beneficial ownership aligned with the Prevention of Money Laundering Rules, 2003, and allows investors with non-controlling beneficial ownership of up to 10 per cent from LBCs to invest in India through the automatic route, subject to

applicable sectoral caps and conditions. The government has also created a fast-track approval mechanism, under which proposals from LBC investors in select manufacturing segments will be processed within 60 days. These sectors include capital goods, electronic capital goods, electronic components, and the polysilicon and ingot-wafer value chain. "It is expected that the new guidelines will provide clarity and ease of doing business in India, and facilitate investments which can contribute towards greater FDI inflows, access to new technologies, domestic value addition, expansion of domestic firms and integration with global supply chain," the statement noted.

War effect: FinMin seeks House nod for ₹1 lakh crore Economic Stabilisation Fund

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

To prepare for unforeseen economic shocks in the context of the war in West Asia, the Finance Ministry on Wednesday sought Parliament approval to establish a ₹1 lakh crore 'Economic Stabilisation Fund'. "The war in the Gulf region is causing a lot of volatility in various markets. To reduce the impact of such extreme volatility, this fund has been proposed," a senior government official told *businessline*. More than half of the requirement of funds will be met through fresh cash outgo, while the rest will come from savings, the document on the second batch of Supplementary Demands for Grants showed. The second batch seeks approval for gross additional

expenditure of over ₹2.81 lakh crore. Of this, the proposals involving net cash outgo aggregate to over ₹2 lakh crore and gross additional expenditure, matched by savings of Ministries/Departments or by enhanced receipts/recoveries add to over ₹80,000 crore. The government sought ₹19,230 crore for the fertiliser department and ₹23,641 crore for subsidies under the PM Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana. Other expenditure heads include ₹41,822 crore for the Defence Ministry. ICRA Chief Economist Aditi Nayar said though the net cash outgo under the second Supplementary Demand for Grants had been pegged at ₹2 lakh crore, this is likely to be offset to a large extent by expenditure savings by Ministries and will not impact the fiscal deficit.

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Fuel price surge pushes Centre to review domestic airfare caps

CRISIS SUPPORT. Government to extend non-financial help to airlines hit by the West Asia disruptions

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Centre is reviewing the existing domestic air fare cap amid rising aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices as well as mounting operational pressures on airlines due to the ongoing crisis in West Asia, sources told *businessline*.

According to sources, the Centre is holding consultations with the industry to arrive at a workable solution as airlines continue to grapple with higher fuel costs, longer flight routes and rising insurance premia.

The Centre had imposed a cap on airfares in early December 2025 after taking cognisance of the unusually high fares amid flight disruptions at IndiGo.

At that time, the Ministry of Civil Aviation had invoked its regulatory powers to en-



OUT OF REACH. Jet fuel costs in Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai and Chennai rose 5.81 per cent in the latest revision

sure fair and reasonable fares across affected routes.

Currently, the cap has been set at ₹7,500 for routes up to 500 km, ₹12,000 for sectors between 500 and 1,000 km, ₹15,000 for routes between 1,000 and 1,500 km and ₹18,000 for sectors above 1,500 km.

However, the fare cap does

not apply to business class travel and flights operated under UDAN.

FINANCIAL WOES Meanwhile, the Centre has decided to extend non-financial support measures to airlines affected by disruptions in the West Asia corridor, sources added.

Airlines had flagged multiple operational and financial challenges to the Ministry of Civil Aviation, including difficulties in route planning and coordination, as they attempt to restore flight connectivity to the West Asia region and beyond.

The crisis in West Asia forced airlines to take longer routes over the Red Sea and Egypt to reach destinations in Europe and North America. The detours have resulted in higher fuel burn and longer flight durations, thereby increasing operating costs.

Airlines are also facing higher insurance premiums as insurers have imposed additional charges due to the heightened regional risks.

Industry estimates suggest that airlines are paying an extra ₹30-40 lakh per narrowbody flight and up to ₹1

crore for widebody operations.

JET FUEL COSTS If these additional costs are passed on to passengers, airfares could increase by ₹20,000-35,000 per passenger on certain routes. Rising fuel prices are adding to the financial pressure on airlines. Jet fuel costs across four major metro cities — Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai and Chennai — rose 5.81 per cent, or ₹5,215.50 per kilolitre, in the latest revision.

In Delhi specifically, the price increased by ₹5,244.75 on March 1, representing a rise of about 5.74 per cent, compared with the February 1 levels.

These prices include Central Excise Duty and State Value Added Tax, and are revised by oil marketing companies on the first day of every month.

CBIC waives ₹1,000 back-to-town fee for export cargo hit by West Asia crisis

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) on Tuesday waived the ₹1,000 fee charged for back-to-town consignments — both sea and air export cargo withdrawn from Customs areas — after shipments were disrupted due to the ongoing West Asia crisis.

In trade parlance, back-to-town refers to the withdrawal of cargo from a Customs area following the cancellation of exports due to reasons such as offloading of goods, flight cancellations or cancellation of export orders.

In such situations, exporters usually withdraw goods quickly to avoid additional charges or deterioration of cargo.

However, when exporters removed shipments due to the current crisis, the Customs authorities in some locations insisted on a ₹1,000 fee for withdrawal. The trade termed the levy unacceptable as the disruption was



HUGE SETBACK. The present circumstances constitute an exceptional situation affecting shipping routes and logistics

beyond the control of the exporters and the Customs brokers.

PAN-INDIA WAIVER While some Customs formations, including those at Kandla, Mundra and Nhava Sheva, have already waived the fee, the relaxation was not uniformly available across the country.

On Tuesday, the CBIC issued a notice extending the waiver across India.

The CBIC said it had taken note of disruptions in inter-

national shipping and logistics routes arising from the ongoing crisis in West Asia.

“The present circumstances constitute an exceptional situation affecting international shipping routes and export logistics,” said the Board. The requirement for amendment or cancellation of documents arises from these exceptional circumstances or other *force majeure* situations, and not due to any lapse on the part of the exporters or the Customs brokers, it said.

‘Electronics, semicon supply chain unhurt; prolonged war may disrupt ops’

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

India’s electronics and semiconductor supply chain has managed to steer clear of disruptions caused by the conflict in West Asia. Industry players, however, flagged risks if the situation drags on.

Industry executives and analysts told *businessline* that electronics exports are mainly routed through air and while shipments to West Asia have stopped, other routes are still operational but at a heavier cost.

With regard to inputs, the industry has visibility of components for 3-4 weeks, but this is contingent on the

movement of goods via sea.

Sasikumar Gendham, President, Electronics Industries Association of India (ELCINA), said that logistics to West Asia is at a standstill right now in terms of exports, although the impact is yet to be directly felt on the shop floor.

“But if the situation prolongs for two more weeks, then there will be challenges,” he said.

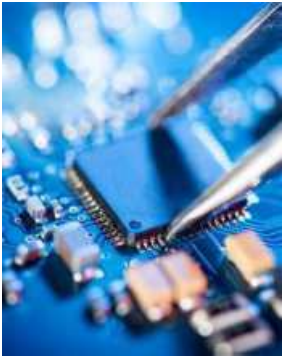
“If the war prolongs and if the biggest player China faces issues with fuel, then we might have a problem with shipping lines operating, impacting Indian industries as well,” he added.

An official at the Indian Electronics and Semiconductor Association said that

operations in the electronics sector are stable, but pressure will start building if the war does not come to an end soon.

VIA AIR ROUTE “Exports in the sector are mainly via the air route and imports of components are largely via sea, so we are closely tracking the situation,” he said. Analysts explained the global nature of the supply chain in this sector and India’s dependencies.

Tarun Pathak, Research Director, Counterpoint Research, noted that gas produced during oil and gas refining is one of the essential materials for semiconductor manufacturing, and pro-



longed geopolitical instability negatively impacts supply chain.

“While bypassing established shipping routes increases logistics costs, the nature of the equipment-intensive industry means the impact on total production

costs is manageable, and manufacturers can easily pass these costs on to customers. However, if geopolitical instability in West Asia persists and energy costs rise sharply, demand growth could slow down faster than supply,” he said.

“The situation is even more critical for downstream products. As data centre customers take up a larger share of the memory supply, traditional sectors such as smartphones, PCs, telecom and consumer electronics face shrinking availability and higher costs,” he adds.

SELF-RELIANCE Others flagged the West Asia turmoil as a catalyst for India

to achieve self-reliance in the electronics and supply chain sector.

“While the flow of chips hasn’t been directly disrupted, the ecosystem remains sensitive to global shocks in energy, logistics or geopolitics that can trigger second- and third-order effects. Situations like these reinforce the importance of strengthening domestic capabilities in both chip design and manufacturing,” said Shashwath TR, Co-founder & CEO of chip design firm Mindgrove Technologies.

“We need not rely solely on homegrown products, but having the capability can better prepare the country for future supply chain shocks,” he said.

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SCAN TO KNOW MORE

Canada calling

Tie-ups spanning energy and education hold promise

Jyoti Vij

Canada’s Prime Minister Mark Carney’s visit to India came at a time when global trade and geopolitics are being reshaped by strategic competition, supply chain realignments and energy transitions. In that context, the visit was not merely a diplomatic engagement but an attempt to reposition India-Canada ties for a more uncertain and multipolar economic landscape.

The visit produced a wide range of agreements across trade, energy, technology and education. Yet the real significance of these outcomes lies not in the number of memoranda signed but in the structural direction they signal for the bilateral relationship.

The most consequential step was the signing of the Terms of Reference (ToR) for the India-Canada Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA). While trade negotiations between the two countries have been discussed for over a decade, the renewed push suggests a recognition on both sides that economic engagement needs a stronger institutional framework.

MODEST TRADE FIGURES Bilateral trade currently stands at \$8.66 billion in 2024-25, a modest figure relative to the size of the two economies. The target of \$50 billion by 2030 therefore represents more than numerical ambition — it reflects the possibility of integrating supply chains between a major advanced economy rich in natural resources and a rapidly growing industrial economy seeking inputs for manufacturing and energy transition.

For India, a trade agreement with Canada could improve access to resources critical to industrial growth, including energy and minerals. For Canada, deeper economic engagement with India offers diversification away from over-dependence on a few traditional markets. In an era where countries are actively seeking trusted economic partners, CEPA has the potential to transform a relationship that has historically underperformed relative to its potential.

Energy cooperation illustrates this shift particularly well. The long-term uranium supply agreement between India’s Department of Atomic Energy and Cameco, one of the world’s largest uranium producers, is strategically significant. India has



CANADIAN PM. Mark Carney has attempted to reposition ties REUTERS

set a target of achieving 100 GW of nuclear power capacity by 2047, and securing stable uranium supplies will be essential for that expansion. For Canada, one of the world’s leading uranium exporters, the partnership provides a reliable long-term market. Equally important is the MoU on critical minerals cooperation, which reflects the growing centrality of minerals such as lithium, cobalt and rare earths to the global clean-energy economy. These materials underpin electric vehicles, battery storage and renewable technologies. By exploring cooperation in exploration, mining and processing, the two countries are positioning themselves within the emerging global race to secure critical mineral supply chains.

Talent mobility and education agreements are another pillar with long-term implications. The partnership between the All India Council for Technical Education and Mitacs to facilitate research internships for Indian students could strengthen academic collaboration and innovation ecosystems in both countries.

Agriculture cooperation also featured prominently, particularly through the proposal to establish a Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence at NIFTEM Kundli. Given that Canada is one of the world’s largest producers of pulses and India is its largest consumer, this initiative could move the relationship beyond commodity trade towards food innovation, processing technologies and nutrition-focused research.

The decision to establish an India-Canada Defence Dialogue signals a recognition that economic and technological partnerships increasingly intersect with strategic considerations.

Taken together, the outcomes of the visit suggest a multi-dimensional strategic economic engagement.

The writer is Director General, FICCI



RAVI VARANASI

The Reserve Bank of India’s proposal to allow banks to lend directly to Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) is a welcome and potentially transformative reform. It signals regulatory confidence in India’s evolving real estate capital markets and recognises the growing importance of REITs as institutional financing vehicles.

However, the long-term success of this reform will depend less on the decision itself but more on how the lending framework is designed and supervised. Done well, this reform can accelerate capital formation and improve real estate governance. Done poorly, it risks recreating legacy real estate credit vulnerabilities that India has spent years trying to correct.

The opportunity is significant. So is the responsibility.

India’s REIT ecosystem continues to lag global benchmarks in depth and scale. This gap persists despite significant expansion in modern logistics infrastructure, commercial office space and organised retail assets, sectors that typically anchor institutional real estate ownership worldwide.

One of the biggest structural constraints has been funding concentration.

Indian REITs have relied predominantly on capital market borrowing through equity issuance and listed debt. While this provides transparency and market discipline, it also introduces cyclicality. Fundraising windows depend heavily on market sentiment and interest rate cycles.

Allowing bank lending introduces financing diversification. It provides REITs with stable credit channels, improves acquisition flexibility and lowers cost of capital.

Most importantly, it strengthens the asset recycling mechanism that allows developers to monetise stabilised assets and redeploy capital into new infrastructure creation.

From a macro perspective, this aligns well with India’s urbanisation and infrastructure growth trajectory.

Historically, India’s banking sector has faced stress primarily from lending



Bank credit may unlock REIT growth

THRUST AREA. Policy design must ensure bank lending to REITs is treated as an income-yield credit product rather than project finance

to real estate development projects rather than stabilised income-generating assets. REITs, by design, are fundamentally different from developers. They hold completed assets with rental cash flows, tenant diversification and disclosure standards. However, if lending frameworks fail to recognise these structural differences, banks may either overestimate or underestimate sector risks.

Policy design must therefore focus on ensuring that bank lending to REITs is treated as an income-yield credit product rather than project finance.

FIVE POLICY DESIGN PRINCIPLES **Cash flow-based lending frameworks** must be mandatory: Traditional real estate lending in India has been asset or collateral driven. REIT lending must instead prioritise cash flow underwriting. Banks should be required to evaluate: lease tenure stability; tenant concentration exposure; occupancy track records; rental escalation visibility; and weighted average lease maturity profiles.

Globally, REIT credit evaluation is

Allowing bank lending provides REITs with stable credit channels, improves acquisition flexibility and lowers cost of capital

driven by rental yield resilience rather than asset valuation alone. Adopting similar frameworks will reduce credit cyclicality.

Conservative leverage guardrails should be preserved: India’s REIT regulations already prescribe leverage limits. Bank lending guidelines should align closely with these caps rather than creating parallel leverage build-up through layered debt structures. Prudential norms could consider: loan-to-value ceilings linked to stabilised asset valuations; debt service coverage ratio thresholds; and restrictions on refinancing that extends beyond underlying lease visibility

This would prevent excessive financial engineering while preserving capital discipline.

Exposure diversification norms for banks are essential: REIT assets are geographically and sectorally concentrated by nature. Bank exposure guidelines must therefore ensure diversification across: multiple REIT sponsors; different asset classes such as office, logistics and retail; and regional concentration risks

Concentration risk has historically amplified banking sector stress in real estate cycles. Preventing such clustering will be critical.

Encourage specialised real estate credit expertise within banks: One under-discussed challenge is the limited institutional experience Indian banks have in underwriting rental yield-based

real estate financing at scale. The RBI could consider encouraging: dedicated real estate credit verticals within banks; sector-specific risk modelling frameworks; and data-driven performance monitoring of REIT assets

Over time, this would help create specialised credit capability comparable to global real estate lending markets.

Align lending incentives with long-term stability: REIT lending should ideally favour stabilised assets rather than aggressive acquisition-driven leverage expansion. Policy incentives could encourage lending structures tied to operational asset performance rather than speculative growth.

This would reinforce the core purpose of REITs as yield vehicles rather than leveraged asset accumulation platforms.

THE WAY FORWARD

The RBI’s move deserves strong support. It reflects regulatory pragmatism and confidence in India’s maturing financial architecture.

The next phase must focus on designing a robust, forward-looking prudential framework that recognises the unique risk profile of REIT financing. Policymakers, banks and market participants should treat this reform as an opportunity to build a globally competitive real estate financing ecosystem rather than merely expanding credit availability.

The writer is Founding Partner, SPRV Consultants

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

March 11, 2006

Roll out CAS in metros: HC

Viewers in Delhi, Mumbai and Kolkata may soon have to buy set-top boxes (STBs) to watch their favourite family soaps or sporting events on various pay channels. In a move that would pave the way for STBs in the three cities, the Delhi High Court on Friday directed the Centre to implement conditional access system (CAS) within four weeks.

Telekom Malaysia buys 49 pc in Spice for \$179 m

Telekom Malaysia (TM) has picked up a 49 per cent stake in Spice Communications Private Ltd for \$178.85 million. The deal will close in a month. The company has pipped rival Maxis Communications in clinching the deal. Spice operates in two circles, Punjab and Karnataka, with a total subscriber base of over 1.8 million.

Bajaj unveils investment plan

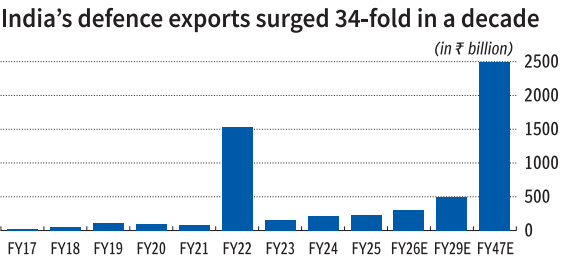
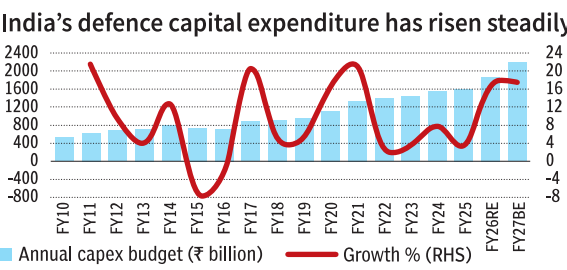
Bajaj Auto Ltd will spend ₹1,500 crore over the next three years for a range of projects, including enhancement of manufacturing capacity from the current 3.5 million vehicles per annum to 5.1 million. Financing would be from the company’s own funds. Products for roll-out include a ‘light cargo four-wheeler.’

STATISTALK.

Compiled by **Dhuraivel Gunasekaran** | Graphic **KS Gunasekar**

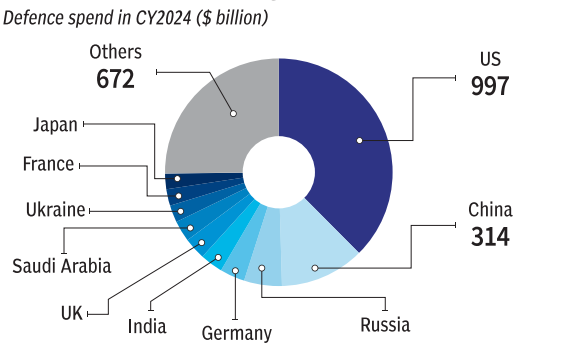
India’s defence shift: Rising capex, falling imports

India stands today as the world’s fourth-largest defence spender, according to an HDFC Securities report. The FY27 Union Budget allocated \$85 billion for defence, up 15% yoy, representing 15% of the Union Budget. India’s defence capex has risen steadily in recent years, reflecting a policy shift towards military modernisation. Higher allocations signal sustained investment in aircraft, ships, drones and advanced technologies. Defence exports have expanded sharply over the past decade, rising more than thirty-four-fold since FY14. This growth reflects policy support, a broader product portfolio and increasing participation of private defence manufacturers. Meanwhile, India’s defence imports declined 9.3% during 2020–24 compared with the previous five years, as import bans and domestic procurement mandates redirect billions towards local manufacturers

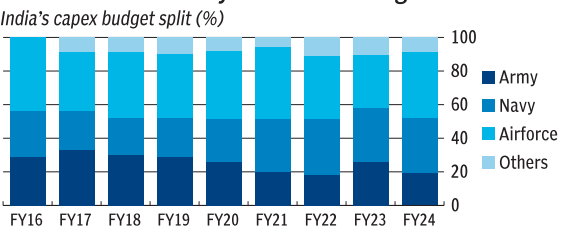


Source: HDFC Securities

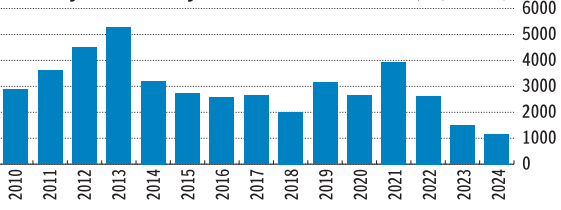
India, the world’s 4th largest defence spender



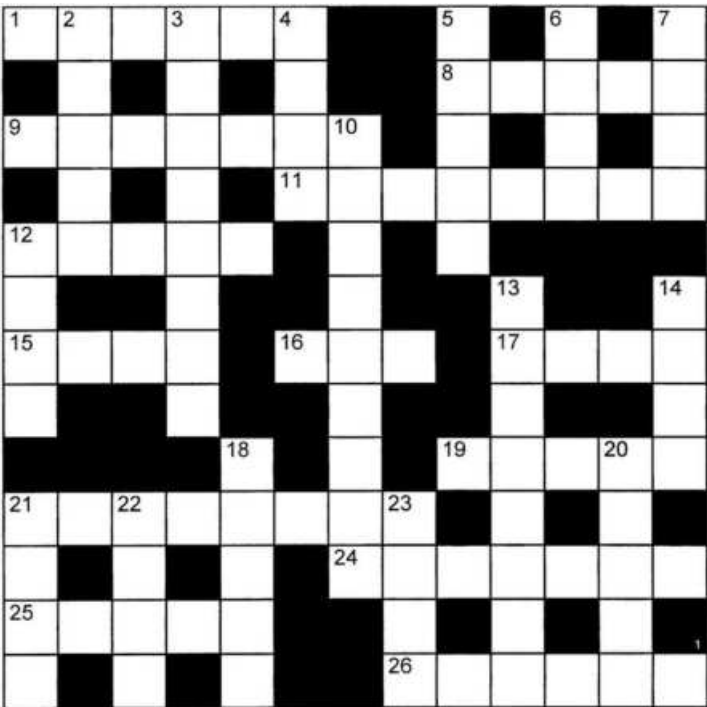
Air Force consistently attracts the largest slice



India pushing for self-reliance as imports decline notably in recent years



BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2634



EASY

ACROSS

- Junkie (6)
- Paragon, finest example (5)
- One believed to have committed crime (7)
- Drift, inclination (8)
- Awn (5)
- Molten volcanic stream (4)
- Use oars (3)
- Wheel-pin (4)
- Opium flower (5)
- Flag, military symbol (8)
- Felt earnest desire (7)
- Guns of ship-of-war (5)
- Food storage room (6)

DOWN

- Two in cards (5)
- Tuft of hair on lower lip (8)
- Adroitness in managing (4)
- Black playing-card (5)
- Grain store (4)
- Be at sport (4)
- Stop-gap (9)
- Concave battle-axe (4)
- Manual worker needing little skill (8)
- Former paper size, roughly A2 (4)
- In a curious way (5)
- Part, portion (5)
- Not different (4)
- Legislative enactments (4)
- Transact business (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- In part of play, did get confused as to the one hooked (6)
- Nacreous concretion right inside ring (5)
- He is, one may think, the perpetrator (7)
- Inclination to finish in letting agreement after an absence (8)
- 5 Down may confront one face to face (5)
- Etna’s spillage will half-land on Virginia (4)
- An argument as to how one will look to pull a boat (3)
- Pin of beer taken around ten (4)
- Form of music party first and last given, California variety (5)
- Sort of rose to be the norm (8)
- Was aching at end of day for it to be gained by Labour (7)
- Surface of road - motorway - has let a change come about (5)
- For storage of menu, it left desktop in the rear perhaps (6)

DOWN

- At cards, two could have been forty all (5)
- Size of old paper - Mail - ripe for development (8)
- Clever handling of situation by Tom returning on time (4)
- One of a suit used in digs (5)
- Advocates collectively go north for this sort of dance (4)
- Drama on words provided by punster (4)
- PM, a Tory, re-assembled it but it wasn’t to last (9)
- What one may be called on to pay the beak (4)
- Workman joins the Socialist party with hesitation (8)
- Size of old paper copy media held up (4)
- Do up in a nonchalant way when one left in a curious manner (5)
- Part and parcel being all of such a man in chess (5)
- Identical to the missile that faced the East (4)
- Parts of 7 are in the Bible (4)
- To be a hander-out of wood (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2633

ACROSS 7. Paraphernalia 8. Malfesance 12. Lilies 14. Seraph 16. Varies 18. Marine 19. Eye for an eye 23. Disinterested

DOWN 1. Balm 2. Wall 3. Sheets 4. Crusts 5. Main 6. Wise 9. Allergy 10. Charity 11. Shoe 12. Live 13. Ere 15. Era 17. Shorts 18. Meagre 19. Evil 20. Epic 21. Ease 22. Ever

QUICKLY.

Global stocks edge up as Trump, Iran trade barbs



Boston/London: Wall Street stocks advanced and oil prices plummeted on Tuesday after US President Donald Trump declared the Middle East war could be “over soon” despite defiant comments from Iran’s military that cast some doubt over the prospects of a swift resolution. The Dow Jones Industrial Average gained 0.4 per cent, the S&P 500 added 0.3 per cent and the Nasdaq Composite rose 0.5 per cent. Europe’s STOXX 600 index pared some earlier gains but was last up 1.65 per cent on Tuesday after declining for three consecutive trading days. MSCI’s broadest index of Asia-Pacific shares outside Japan rose around 3.4 per cent. REUTERS

Motilal Oswal Wealth launches bond platform

Mumbai: Motilal Oswal Financial Services’ wealth management arm on Tuesday launched a digital bonds trading platform to enable investors to access fixed income securities. The company said its newly launched Bond Provider Platform will allow investors to invest in government securities, PSU bonds and corporate bonds through a dedicated digital interface. The move comes as the domestic bond market expands and investors increasingly seek predictable returns and capital preservation alongside equity investments. India’s bond market has grown to nearly \$3 trillion, making it the third-largest in Asia after Japan and China, and equivalent to roughly 100-110 per cent of India’s GDP, a release said. m

Inflows into equity mutual funds rise 8% in February to ₹25,978 crore

TOP PICKS. Flexi-cap and mid-cap funds remain attractive collecting ₹6,925 cr and ₹4,003 cr: AMFI data

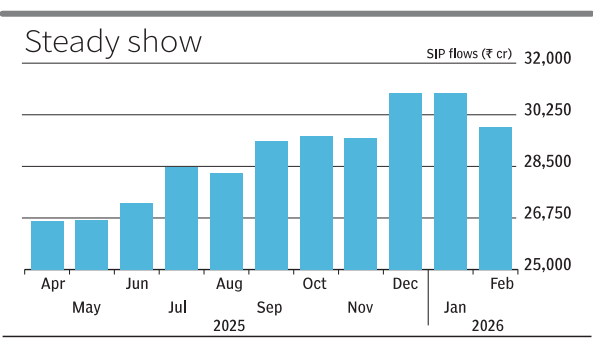
Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Equity inflows into mutual fund schemes rose 8 per cent in February to ₹25,978 crore, up from ₹24,029 crore in January, as investors used the market correction to accumulate more units. Flexi-cap and mid-cap funds continued to attract the highest inflows at ₹6,925 crore (₹7,672 crore) and ₹4,003 crore (₹3,185 crore) respectively, according to data released by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) on Tuesday.

SIP INFLOWS DIP

However, systematic investment plan (SIP) inflows fell to ₹29,845 crore from

₹31,002 crore in January, largely because mutual funds lost four days of debit mandates in February. Venkat Chalasani, Chief Executive of AMFI, said that apart from the shorter month, February 28 was a bank holiday, meaning instalments scheduled for the last four days will now be reflected in March collections. On the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) decision to discontinue Children’s and Retirement fund schemes, Chalasani said AMFI had made a representation to the regulator citing difficulties in closing the schemes with “immediate effect”, following which the deadline was extended to March-end. “We will make another



representation highlighting the hardship investors may face due to the closure of these two schemes and await the regulator’s final decision,” he added. Children’s and Retirement schemes together have 62.86 lakh folios, with ₹247 crore in inflows and assets under management (AUM) of ₹57,663 crore as of February-end.

HYBRID, ETF FLOWS

Hybrid schemes saw 31 per cent lower inflows at ₹11,983 crore, compared with ₹17,356 crore in January, largely due to a decline in multi-asset scheme inflows to ₹8,476 crore (₹10,485

crore). Gold ETFs attracted ₹5,255 crore, sharply lower than ₹24,040 crore in January, while silver ETFs recorded a net outflow of ₹826 crore, compared with an inflow of ₹9,463 crore in the previous month. Suranjana Borthakur, Head of Distribution & Strategic Alliances at Mirae Asset Investment Managers India, said that moderating valuations in the broader markets appear to be strengthening investor confidence in long-term prospects. Nehal Meshram, Senior Analyst-Manager Research at Morningstar Investment Research India, said that despite the moderation, inflows into gold ETFs highlight sustained investor interest in gold-backed products.

‘IPO market enters maturity phase’

Our Bureau
Mumbai

India’s capital markets are transitioning from a pure capital-raising platform to a valuation discovery engine, driven by strong domestic liquidity, sustained investor participation and a robust IPO pipeline, according to a capital markets outlook report by Uniquis Consultech, in partnership with the Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association. The report noted that India’s equity market capitalisation stood at about \$5.2 trillion in 2025, reinforcing the country’s position as one of the most resilient global capital markets despite global volatility.

India’s IPO market remained active in 2025, with companies raising ₹1.76 lakh crore, a 10 per cent increase from the previous year. However, the composition of fundraising indicates a shift in strategy: about 63-64 per cent of proceeds came from offer-for-sale (OFS) components, reflecting promoter monetisation at favourable valuations rather than fresh capital infusion. Where fresh capital was raised, companies largely prioritised balance-sheet strengthening. Around 32 per cent of IPO proceeds were used for working capital, 27 per cent for debt repayment and 18 per cent for capital expenditure, suggesting a focus on financial stability and operational resilience

rather than aggressive expansion.

APPETITE FOR IPOs

Despite moderating debut performances, investor appetite remained strong. Average listing gains dropped sharply to about 10 per cent in 2025 from around 30per cent in 2024, signalling more rational pricing, though overall subscription levels remained robust. Looking ahead, the pipeline remains strong, with around 200 draft IPO documents filed with the SEBI representing potential issuance of over ₹1.8 lakh crore, indicating that 2026 could witness a deeper and broader IPO cycle anchored by domestic liquidity and structural growth expectations.

Brokers told to disclose, remit excess STT retained

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange of India Ltd (NSE) has asked brokers and sub-brokers to disclose and remit any excess Securities Transaction Tax (STT) collected from investors but not deposited with the government for FY24 and earlier year. In a circular issued on Tuesday, the exchange said the move follows a communication from the Joint Commissioner of Income Tax, Range 7(1), which flagged that some market intermediaries had collected STT in excess of the applicable amount and retained it instead of remitting it to the

government account. Brokers have been directed to furnish details of such excess STT collected and retained as of March 31, 2023 directly to the exchange. They have been given seven days from the date of the circular to comply and must submit the information with the caption “Excess STT Retained – NSE”. The circular said the Income Tax department had sent a communication on March 5, asking the exchange to issue a notice requesting all brokers and sub-brokers to disclose details of excess STT collected for FY24 and preceding years. Members have also been instructed to remit the excess



STT along with interest at 1 per cent for every month of delay to the exchange immediately, under intimation to the tax department. NSE will subsequently deposit the recovered amount into the government account. This directive is a follow-up to an earlier circular issued by the exchange on March 19, 2025, which had sought similar disclosures

from brokers for FY23 and prior years.

COLLECTIONS SURGE

Introduced in 2004, STT is a key source of tax revenue from securities market transactions, levied on the purchase and sale of equities and certain derivatives. Collections have risen sharply in recent years alongside a surge in trading activity. STT collections increased from ₹23,191 crore in FY22 to ₹25,085 crore in FY23 and further to ₹33,778 crore in FY24. The growth accelerated in FY25, with collections jumping to ₹52,197 crore. For FY26, the government has estimated STT collections of ₹63,670 crore in the revised estimates.

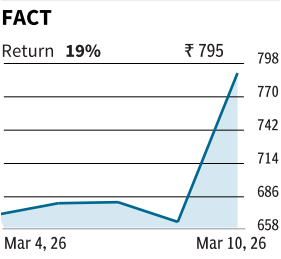
Fertilizer stocks jump as govt calms nerves, but analysts worry over war

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Fertilizer stocks rallied sharply up to 20 per cent on Tuesday after the government introduced new regulations aimed at ensuring steady natural gas availability for priority sectors amid the West Asia conflict, triggering strong investor interest across the segment. Fertilizers and Chemicals Travancore (FACT), Rashtriya Chemicals and Fertilizers (RCF), Chambal Fertilisers, Deepak Fertilisers, Paradeep Phosphates, and Gujarat Narmada Valley Fertilizers & Chemicals rallied between 5 per cent and 20 per cent. Among them, FACT settled 20 per cent higher at its upper circuit (₹795.10) on the BSE. RCF zoomed over 16 per cent to close at ₹127.80.

GAS REGULATION

The rally followed the government’s issuance of the



Natural Gas Regulation Order, 2026, to regulate the supply of natural gas to the domestic piped natural gas supply, compressed natural gas for transport, LPG production, pipeline compressor fuel and others. To fertilizer units, it will be capped at 70 per cent of the last six-month average. Antu Eapen Thomas, Research Analyst, Geojit Investments, said investors will closely monitor signs of geopolitical de-escalation. Pertaining to the latest order, he said, the current lean season and advancement of maintenance at certain facilities are expected to ease

near-term gas demand.

FORCE MAJEURE

Global natural gas supply chains have been under strain after Qatar Energy declared *force majeure* on certain shipments disrupting contracted supplies and forcing several client nations and companies to reassess procurement strategies. According to ICRA Research, the rise in ammonia as well as LNG prices may impact the profitability of phosphorus and potassium fertilizer players unless subsidy corrections are made in the upcoming nutrient-based subsidy rate revision. Urea prices have increased on March 4 to around \$597/t from around \$484/t on February 27. “As the current situation reflects lack of availability of supplies along with constrained domestic production, India faces an uphill task to maintain a reasonable level of availability of fertilisers for the upcoming season, it cautioned.

SAT upholds SEBI action against Sahara firm over OFCD issue

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai



The Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) has upheld regulatory action taken by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) against Sahara India Commercial Corporation Ltd (SICCL) in a case related to the issuance of optionally fully convertible debentures (OFCDs). A three-member SAT Bench dismissed appeals filed by the company and its directors against SEBI’s October 2018 directions requiring the firm to refund money raised through the debentures, disclose details of its inventory, and barring certain officials from accessing the securities market. The tribunal held that the OFCDs issued by SICCL between 1998 and 2008

amounted to a public offer, placing them within SEBI’s regulatory jurisdiction. **INVESTOR MOBILISATION** According to the order, the company raised about ₹14.106 crore from nearly 1.98 crore investors through these debentures during the period. SAT said such large-scale fund mobilisation from millions of investors could not be treated as a private placement, as claimed by the company. “The mobilisation of funds from nearly 1.98 crore investors clearly indicates

that the issuance of OFCDs was in the nature of a public issue,” the tribunal observed. Since SICCL did not seek permission from bourses or obtain regulatory approval from SEBI, the tribunal held that the issuance violated Section 73 of the Companies Act. Sahara’s counsel argued that SEBI’s refund direction was misplaced, as most of the funds had already been repaid or adjusted. The company claimed that about ₹4,400 crore worth of OFCDs had been converted into equity shares, ₹1,527.76 crore repaid by cheque, and ₹8,157.80 crore refunded in cash, leaving only about ₹17 crore outstanding. However, SAT rejected these claims, saying the company failed to produce credible evidence of repayment to such a large investor base.

BROKER’S CALL.

HDFC Securities

AMBUJA CEMENTS (BUY)

Target: ₹680
CMP: ₹462.30
We interacted with Ambuja Cements’ management during a visit to its Sanghipuram plant arranged by the company. The Management highlighted that overall demand momentum remains healthy which has aided cement price recovery. Opex is also expected to reduce q-o-q driving margin stabilisation. Focus remains on profitable growth over aggressive organic expansion, achieving cost reduction targets and selling more premium cement. During the Sanghipuram plant visit, management showcased the ongoing plant infrastructure revamp which is reducing the plant opex (more in the offing) and also noted its potential to double the plant capacity in near future. We remain positive on Ambuja, which we expect to deliver about 100-200 bps volume growth ahead of the industry each year over FY26-28E, accompanied by a gradual margin improvement driven by opex reduction. We trim our EBITDA estimates for FY26/27/28E by 2/5/6 per cent, owing to two factors: about 2 per cent reduction in our volume CAGR assumption, and lower margin estimates to account for an expected rise in fuel costs. We also trim our capex outgo estimates for FY26-28E to ₹33,200 crore from ₹37,000 crore earlier, as we build in a slower pace of capacity additions given management’s stated focus on margins over aggressive expansion. We maintain Buy with a revised target price of ₹680/share (16.5x its Mar’28E consolidated EBITDA). Previous target price was ₹700.

Elara Securities

LG ELECTRONICS (ACCUMULATE)

Target: ₹1,750
CMP: ₹1,573.10
LG Electronics India is the undisputed leader in India’s consumer durable market, with decade-long dominance in the space. LGEL is re-entering the economy segment via its LG Essential series in tier II-III markets and in the traditional channel, initially in refrigerators and washing machines, followed by room air conditioners and microwaves. We believe LGEL will see accelerated revenue growth of 14-16 per cent (upside case) in FY26E-30E over a large base from the current growth of 11 per cent if it were to mirror Haier’s blueprint of aggressive pricing, large capex and surging localisation, while preserving superior return profile. An earnings CAGR of 18 per cent in FY26E-28E should be underpinned by: rising localisation with backward integration into products such as compressors and PCBs, unlike domestic peers; strong parental support for R&D and technology, enabling bridging product gaps between the parent and India operations; and premium portfolio with leadership in high-value categories. LGEL is incurring a capex of ₹5,000 crore at Sri City, Tamil Nadu in the next four years. This may translate into revenue of ₹20,000-25,000 crore (asset turnover at 4-4.5x) once fully ramped up. We initiate with Accumulate and a TP of ₹1,750, based on 45x FY28E P/E. Key risks are slowdown in demand in India’s consumer durables industry, intensifying competitive landscape, inability to pass on price rise and contingent liability related to royalty payment to the parent.

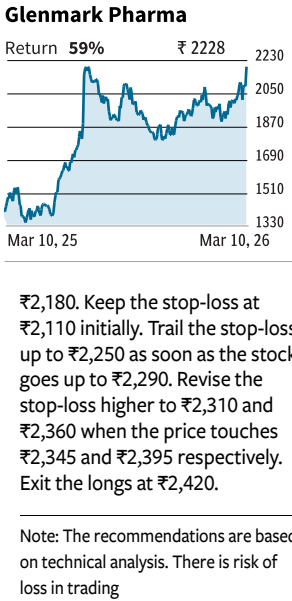
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TODAY’S PICK.

Glenmark Pharmaceuticals (₹2,228.25): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Glenmark Pharmaceuticals. The 5 per cent rise on Tuesday confirms an inverted head and shoulder pattern on the chart. This indicates that the broader uptrend has resumed. The neckline support of this pattern is around ₹2,140. Moving average cross overs on the daily chart also strengthens the bullish case. So, any dips from here can be limited. Glenmark Pharmaceuticals share price can rise to ₹2,450 initially and then ₹2,600 eventually in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Glenmark Pharmaceuticals shares now at ₹2,228. Accumulate on dips at



Day trading guide

24405 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24280	24160	24435	24580	Go long on a break above 24435. Keep the stop-loss at 24390	
₹850 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
843	835	857	870	Wait for dips. Go long at 845 with a stop-loss at 841	
₹1297 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1280	1265	1325	1380	Go long only above 1325. Keep the stop-loss at 1315	
₹310 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
307	303	312	316	Take fresh longs only above 312 with a stop-loss at 310	
₹270 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
268	265	273	276	Go short below 268. Stop-loss can be kept at 269	
₹1411 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1400	1390	1430	1455	Go long only above 1430. Keep the stop-loss at 1420	
₹1114 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1100	1080	1130	1150	Take fresh shorts below 1100. Keep the stop-loss at 1110	
₹2517 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2490	2440	2530	2580	Go long on a break above 2530. Keep the stop-loss at 2520	
S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.					

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 233.55 pts.
	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(t)	
ICICI Bank	1311.90	52.49	16.57	8.47	
HDFC Bank	849.45	29.36	16.88	11.75	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1062.90	23.26	21.86	1.35	
M&M	2393.70	20.78	24.23	2.66	
Axis Bank	1314.70	16.60	15.45	3.41	
State Bank	1112.20	12.47	11.86	4.17	
Maruti Suzuki	13867.00	10.33	29.20	1.65	
Kotak Bank	391.85	8.87	20.73	2.61	
L&T	3876.00	8.73	28.10	4.12	
Eicher Motors	7536.50	8.17	38.59	0.94	
Tata Steel	195.00	7.24	26.69	1.46	
UltraTech Cement	11654.00	7.18	44.81	1.25	
Int'l GlobeAvi	4380.40	7.13	52.74	0.90	
ITC	309.05	6.45	18.70	2.69	
Tata Motors PV	345.20	6.06	46.94	0.65	
Asian Paints	2280.40	5.91	55.94	0.93	
Bajaj Auto	9610.00	5.52	30.21	0.96	
Titan	4220.10	5.51	78.61	1.57	
Grasim Ind	2743.90	5.25	19.72	0.95	
SBI Life	1963.70	5.04	79.43	0.80	
Bharat Elec	463.35	4.71	56.80	1.50	
JSW Steel	1214.30	4.47	38.24	1.03	
Dr Reddys Lab	1314.60	3.69	19.87	0.72	
Hindalco	956.60	3.57	13.37	1.25	
PowerGrid Corp	298.65	3.43	17.89	1.22	
Bajaj Finserv	1867.80	3.30	15.54	0.97	
Coal India	445.55	2.94	9.19	0.91	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	236.00	2.70	93.43	0.70	
Wipro	280.93	1.37	38.80	0.52	
Trent Ltd.	37.15	1.26	61.54	0.75	
Sun Pharma	1812.80	1.25	39.71	1.74	
NTPC	377.30	1.09	14.74	1.62	
Cipla	1333.50	1.05	23.76	0.68	
Bajaj Finance	939.80	1.02	31.91	2.26	
NestleIndia	1241.20	0.85	73.38	0.80	
HCL Tech	1361.50	0.67	22.43	1.30	
HDFC Life	656.10	0.55	74.89	0.64	
Apollo Hosp	7803.00	0.54	60.13	0.73	
Adani Ports	1424.10	0.45	26.26	0.95	
Max Healthcare	1043.10	0.26	71.50	0.77	
Tech Mahindra	1336.60	0.04	28.52	0.77	
Adani Entrep	1996.50	-0.15	16.31	0.87	
TataConsumerProduct	1099.50	-0.43	73.94	0.65	
Hind Unilever	2190.20	-0.86	51.18	1.76	
ONGC	269.20	-1.36	7.53	0.95	
TCS	2513.10	-3.20	18.96	2.32	
Eternal Ltd.	226.62	-4.63	946.74	1.47	
Bharti Airtel	1850.40	-9.36	28.48	4.66	
Infosys	1295.60	-14.91	18.76	4.10	
Reliance Ind	1408.80	-22.51	19.50	8.60	
Pts: Impact on index movement					
Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 1,157.30 pts.
	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(t)	
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3785.10	110.81	58.89	3.97	
Power Finance	412.15	84.53	4.07	2.68	
Saamradhorthersoninternat	123.41	72.36	35.79	2.45	
Vedanta	722.00	64.13	17.04	5.47	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	728.20	63.14	103.36	2.23	
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1621.90	49.36	28.24	3.06	
Jindal Steel	1187.20	48.32	60.07	1.98	
Indian Hotels Co.	629.40	46.64	41.39	2.47	
United Spirits	1407.10	45.46	59.50	1.85	
Tata Power	381.30	42.32	24.33	2.86	
PfizerInd	1427.70	38.48	62.79	1.98	
Abb India	6224.50	38.08	78.22	1.46	
Godrej Consumer	1111.60	37.79	62.44	2.00	
Rural Elec	334.40	37.47	5.11	1.86	
Bank Of Baroda	294.40	35.34	7.75	2.44	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1013.60	33.51	51.08	1.57	
HindustanAeronautics	4040.10	28.58	30.37	3.42	
Britannia Ind	5968.00	27.60	59.49	3.14	
Punjab Natl Bank	117.53	25.45	7.56	1.81	
Canara Bank	142.27	23.87	7.01	2.14	
Mazagon Dock	2482.10	21.68	41.60	0.84	
Havells	1358.00	20.13	57.44	1.53	
Siemens Energy India .	2957.60	19.74	89.16	1.17	
Hindus Zinc	589.95	19.94	21.12	1.14	
Adipharma Cements	462.10	18.57	23.21	1.26	
JSW Steel	954.65	18.48	23.67	1.67	
Torrent Pharma	4427.80	16.98	65.96	2.07	
Adani Railway Finance Corp	100.71	16.83	18.78	0.80	
Divis Lab	6372.00	16.01	68.24	3.61	
JS Energy .	488.70	15.78	32.81	1.17	
Siemens	23860.00	14.85	48.13	1.43	
Bosch	3208.00	12.49	34.32	2.62	
Shree Cement	3274.90	12.20	73.56	1.29	
Macrotech Developers .	901.95	11.06	26.93	1.13	
Yudhiselfinances	923.10	10.70	18.48	1.03	
Lic	821.40	10.66	9.90	1.18	
Gail (India)	150.29	10.60	11.48	1.81	
Hyundai Motor India .	904.05	6.67	29.14	3.34	
Bajaj Holdings	10289.00	5.07	12.78	1.39	
Bajaj Housing Finance .	84.60	4.78	28.45	0.35	
AdaniGreenenergy	856.50	2.53	76.05	1.17	
Limintreed	4323.10	1.64	27.13	1.79	
ICI Lombard Cg	1889.30	-0.29	34.44	2.04	
Adani Power	-2.01	-2.01	23.71	1.41	
Info Edge	976.60	-1.15	37.58	1.69	
Venus Beverages .	345.60	-5.13	48.21	2.67	
Aravind	3946.80	-8.57	89.67	2.59	
Solar Industries	154.90	-19.34	61.23	2.67	
Indian Oil Corp	14720.00	-18.78	87.25	1.60	
Bpcl	325.90	-30.53	5.75	2.82	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

QUICKLY.

Borosil to set up glass plant in Gujarat's Bharuch

Ahmedabad: Borosil's board approved a new glassware manufacturing facility in Bharuch, Gujarat, along with plans to expand borosilicate glass furnace capacity at its Jaipur plant in Rajasthan, as the company looks to cater to rising demand. The company will invest ₹42 crore to establish the facility in Bharuch, with commercial production expected to begin by December 2026, subject to approvals. OUR BUREAU

Home appliances maker Nuuk, Zetwerk sign deal

Bengaluru: D2C home appliances company Nuuklife Consumer Pvt Ltd has partnered with Zetwerk to expand manufacturing in India. Nuuk has entered a multi-year manufacturing partnership with Zetwerk as part of its plan to build production capacity. The agreement outlines a phased localisation roadmap to expand manufacturing. The collaboration will focus on production scale and supply chain development. OUR BUREAU

PSBs made over ₹28,000 cr in 5 years by selling 3rd party financial products

BANK-WISE. SBI top earner followed by Punjab National Bank, Canara Bank, BoB and Union Bank of India

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Public sector banks earned over ₹28,600 crore in five years by sale of third party financial products, Finance Ministry's data presented in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday showed. Such products include insurance (life and non-life), mutual funds, credit cards and demat accounts.

This data is critical as Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman recently asked banks once again to focus on core business, saying they are spending more time on selling insurance. This trend is also referred to as mis-selling.

In a written reply, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary stated that as per the Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks – Undertaking of Financial Services) Directions, 2025, commercial banks, including

public sector banks (PSBs) are permitted to act as agents of a third-party product or service provider, to facilitate the sale of the latter's financial products or services (e.g., insurance, mutual fund, pension fund and so on) to its customers.

The Minister presented public bank-wise data, which showed SBI was the top earner followed by Punjab National Bank, Canara Bank, Bank of Baroda and Union Bank of India during the last five years.

Further, Chaudhary said the RBI recently issued draft directions under Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks - Responsible Business Conduct) Amendment Directions, 2026. These contain comprehensive instructions to all commercial banks, including *inter-alia*, to ensure their policies and practices neither create incentives for mis-selling nor encourage employees to 'push' the sale of products,



along with directives to ensure that no incentive is directly/indirectly received by the employees engaged in marketing/sales of third-party products from the third-party.

"The draft directions also directs commercial banks to put in place a comprehensive policy for marketing and sales of their own/third-

Earnings by sale of 3rd party products

Bank	Amount
State Bank of India	17,043.49
Punjab National Bank	2,865.54
Canara Bank	2,059.54
Bank of Baroda	1,904.52
Union Bank of India	1,832.69
Bank of India	1,052.91
Indian Bank	629.13
Central Bank of India	522.9
UCO Bank	234.09
Indian Overseas Bank	202.98
Bank of Maharashtra	184.42
Punjab & Sind Bank	114.15
Total	28,646.75

Source: Rajya Sabha

about more focus on selling other products drew ire from Sitharaman.

"Banks should concentrate on their core business. My pet peeve has always been, you're spending more time on selling insurance when it is not required, and conveniently, it fell between two stools (of RBI and IRDAI)," she said while addressing a press conference after customary post-Budget address to the central board of the RBI.

AN OFFENCE

She expressed satisfaction over the RBI's draft proposal on checking the mis-selling. "The message should go to the banks that you cannot afford to mis-sell. Mis-selling is an offence," she said.

"Why should a customer asking for a home loan with collateral, why should he take another insurance cover? Glad that the RBI clarified to banks that they cannot mis-sell," she added.

Last month, complaints

Clearer exits emerge for D2C start-ups as FMCG firms step up acquisitions

Jyoti Banthia
Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Valuation benchmarks for India's direct-to-consumer (D2C) brands are beginning to shift as large fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) companies move from passive observers to active acquirers, creating clearer exit pathways for venture capital and private equity investors.

Recent strategic investments, such as Marico acquiring a majority stake in nutrition brand Cosmix and Dabur picking up a stake in skincare label RAS Luxury Skincare, are early signals of a broader consolidation wave in India's consumer start-up ecosystem.

MATURING MARKET

Industry investors say these deals reflect a maturing market where digital-first brands are increasingly being built with the potential to eventually be folded into the portfolios of large FMCG companies.

"FMCG has generally been among the most acquisitive sectors globally. The fact that we are now starting to see this happen in India speaks to the market maturing to allow niche brands to emerge and validate a customer need that larger FMCG companies can then acquire and expand to a broader base," said Sandeep Murthy, Partner and Managing Director at Lightbox.

Murthy added that the emergence of credible acquisition pathways improves investor confidence and can support stronger valuations for start-ups in the sector.

"Valuation uplift is less due to the strategic investors joining but more due to the fact that the exit channel is real," he said, noting that

private investors are still willing to enter at relatively rich multiples if they expect companies to grow into those valuations over time.

Over the past few years, several FMCG majors have stepped up acquisitions of digital-first brands to strengthen presence in emerging categories. Hindustan Unilever took full ownership of nutrition brand OZiva under a pre-agreed framework after scaling the business, while ITC increased its stake in baby-care brand Mother Sparsh to gain full control of a digital-first play.

However, investors caution the valuation uplift is selective rather than universal.

"The valuation uplift is selective. Brands demonstrating strong repeat cohort behaviour, omni-channel strength and high gross margins are the primary beneficiaries," said Sanchayan Chakraborty, Partner at Aavishkaar Capital. Strategic buyers are increasingly focused on scalable brands with disciplined operations and predictable economics, he said. Deals across beauty, wellness, nutrition and food segments, including acquisitions by companies such as Tata Consumer Products and Marico, demonstrate a growing willingness among large consumer companies to pay premiums for brands that bring differentiated products and strong digital distribution.

For founders and early investors, this trend is expanding the range of exit options beyond public listings. "When a market offers consolidation opportunities, it is attractive to all investors. D2C businesses now have many options for exits... more options means better value," Lightbox's Murthy noted.

SEZ policy panel to review impact, conduct cost-benefit analysis

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The Centre is set to evaluate the impact of implemented and proposed reforms in the Special Economic Zone (SEZ) policy, including the relaxation for domestic sales announced in the Budget 2026-27, to decide on further steps to improve the scheme's performance.

The recently announced committee for "larger reforms in SEZ policy" will review the fiscal impact of SEZs and related reforms on

revenue and taxes, including foregone duties, and assess the cost-benefit outcomes in terms of exports, investment and economic activity, according to the terms of reference (ToR).

"...Recommend short-term, medium-term and long-term policy, legal and procedural reforms, including possible amendments to the SEZ Act/Rules, and suggest an implementation roadmap with clear guidelines," the ToR read.

The committee, steered by the Commerce Department and including repres-

entatives from the Finance Ministry and NITI Aayog, has been tasked with undertaking a background study focused on the harmonisation of various export promotion schemes, including SEZs, EOUs, Manufacture and Other Operations in Warehouse (MOOWR), Advance Authorisation, EPCG and DFIA. It will submit a concept paper recommending a roadmap for broad-based reforms to formulate the SEZ 2.0 policy.

The Commerce Department has been actively discussing proposals with the

Finance Ministry on measures to boost the manufacturing competitiveness of SEZs and make them more attractive, particularly after the sunset clause on income-tax exemptions took effect in April 2020.

‘ENDLESS LOOP’

The recent focus has also been on measures that could help SEZ exporters better leverage the domestic market as they grapple with global uncertainties and US tariffs.

The industry, however, is looking for fast implementa-

tion of measures already discussed within the government for long. "The measures on SEZs taken by the government so far are in very small doses while the big proposals have been consistently put off. A number of studies, including the Baba Kalyani report, the World FZO report and the DESH Bill, have examined SEZ reforms. What is required is the implementation of the recommendations that the government is ready for. We can't keep moving in this endless loop," an industry official told *businessline*.

Responding to long-standing industry demands and global disruptions due to US tariffs, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman proposed a special one-time measure allowing SEZ manufacturing units to sell goods in the Domestic Tariff Area (DTA) at concessional duty rates.

SEZ units, however, have been seeking such concessions on a permanent basis. The industry has long demanded that SEZ units be allowed to sell in the DTA on a "duty-foregone" basis to reduce the duty burden.

TVS Supply Chain sets up unit near Chennai to manage global sourcing for Caterpillar

Our Bureau
Chennai

TVS Supply Chain Solutions Ltd, the Chennai-based supply chain solutions provider, announced it is strengthening Caterpillar's global supply chains from India by setting up a 40,000 sq ft warehousing facility at the Free Trade and Warehousing Zone (FTWZ) in Mannur village, approximately 30 km from Chennai.

The facility "will enable

parts procurement from multiple countries and support Caterpillar's manufacturing operations".

The TVS SCS Chennai FTWZ is located along the Chennai-Bengaluru Industrial Corridor and offers strong connectivity to Chennai, Ennore, and Kamarajar ports, which together handle nearly 20 per cent of India's container traffic. The facility reinforces the 'Make in India for the World' initiative and positions Caterpillar's India as a resilient and scalable

base within their global supply network.

With approximately 4,000 pallet positions, the modern facility will enable Caterpillar to optimise lead times, reduce landed costs, and respond swiftly to global demand and supply needs.

Ravi Viswanathan, Managing Director, TVS Supply Chain Solutions, said: "By combining the FTWZ model with our end-to-end warehousing capabilities, we enable faster and more efficient global supply chain move-

ments, helping Caterpillar withstand trade disruptions."

DEEP EXPERTISE

Ramesh Muthuraman, Director, Operations, Caterpillar India, added: "As we continue to strengthen our global supply chain network, the FTWZ facility established by TVS Supply Chain Solutions enhances our sourcing flexibility. TVS SCS has deep expertise in managing complex, multi-country supply chains..."

Euler Motors signals Hero MotoCorp stake raise as EV maker scales capacity

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Hero MotoCorp is set to increase its investment in electric commercial vehicle maker Euler Motors with an additional ₹275 crore, which will raise the two-wheeler major's stake in the start-up from 34.1 per cent to about 36 per cent on a fully diluted basis.

The investment comes as demand for electric cargo vehicles gathers pace in India's last-mile logistics and urban freight segments, prompting Euler to accelerate manufacturing expansion and product development. Founder and CEO Saurav Kumar indicated the development was underway and would be finalised soon. "It is in the works. Give me a couple of days or weeks and I will come back with the full picture," he told *businessline*.

CAPEX PLAN

Euler has outlined a ₹300-400 crore capital expenditure plan over the next 18-24 months to expand production facilities and strengthen its electric commercial vehicle portfolio.

The company currently operates three manufacturing facilities in Palwal, Haryana. As part of its expansion



GROWTH ARC. Euler Founder Saurav Kumar indicated the development was well underway and would be finalised soon

strategy, it is adding new production lines and dedicated manufacturing space for electric four-wheelers.

Across its facilities, Euler plans to scale production capacity from about 1,000 vehicles per month per shift to around 2,000 vehicles per month per shift, with flexibility to add additional shifts as demand grows.

Euler initially built its presence in the electric three-wheeler cargo segment through its flagship Hi-Load platform, which now has more than 10,000 vehicles on the road serving logistics and e-commerce operators.

However, the company's business mix is increasingly shifting towards electric four-wheel cargo vehicles. Euler has introduced two

models — the Storm EV and Turbo EV1000 — which have been witnessing impressive numbers. According to Kumar, the company now commands roughly 20 per cent share in the electric four-wheel cargo segment, placing it among the top three players in the category. Even as Euler scales operations, EV start-ups are seeking greater policy support to strengthen domestic manufacturing capabilities.

Start-ups including Euler Motors and Ather Energy have written to the government seeking modifications to the automotive production linked incentive (PLI) scheme, arguing that companies investing heavily in EV-focused manufacturing and research should also be eligible for incentives.

Kirloskar Oil Engines unveils succession plan

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Kirloskar Oil Engines Ltd (KOEL) announced a leadership transition as part of its succession plan, appointing Rahul Kirloskar as Chairperson of the board, while Managing Director Gauri Kirloskar will assume the additional role of Vice-Chairperson. The changes will take effect from April 1, 2026, following the retirement of Atul Kirloskar as Chairman on March 31, 2026, after reaching the company's retirement age of 70.

Atul Kirloskar will step down from the board and all positions after more than four decades of association with the group firm.

He joined the company in 1983 and went on to serve in several leadership roles, including Managing Director, Vice-Chairman, and later Chairman and Managing Director.

"We have been working on this transition for the last couple of years as a planned succession. Timely leadership transition is important so that the new leadership gets the freedom to take the company forward in line with its vision," Atul Kirloskar said.

Invesco Mutual Fund

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CAUTIONARY NOTICE

Fake WhatsApp group impersonating Invesco Mutual Fund

IMPORTANT ALERT FOR ATTENTION OF PUBLIC:

It has come to the notice of Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd. ("IAM"), the investment manager of schemes of Invesco Mutual Fund ("IMF") that fake/ fraudulent/ deceptive WhatsApp groups under various names such as 'WWR22', 'M1 Invesco Asset Management India Analysis Team', '03-Invesco Group India Equity Research Team', etc. impersonating IAM have been formed and are engaging in fraudulent activities by providing stock recommendations/ investment advice by unauthorizedly using the names and photos of our employees, our name and logo. Kindly take notice that such groups are designed to defraud the public.

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For Invesco Asset Management (India) Private Limited
(Investment Manager for Invesco Mutual Fund)

Sd/-

Saurabh Nanavati

Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

Date: March 10, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

QUICKLY.

IDFC First pays ₹55 crore more in Chandigarh case

Mumbai: After having repaid ₹590 crore to various departments of the Haryana government due to a fraud at its Chandigarh branch, IDFC First Bank said it has paid an incremental ₹55 crore to the State government as part of reconciliation. “We would like to confirm that these claims pertain to the same incident and linked to the same branch and not a new incident. There are no other pending claims. The bank has made the said payment to the concerned clients in line with our principled approach on this matter of making good the client payments,” the bank said in an exchange notice. OUR BUREAU

SBI shuns Russian crude oil payments

The State Bank of India is not willing to process payments for Russian oil even after the US government issued a temporary waiver for India’s imports, as the country’s largest lender is uncertain how long the concession will last, according to people familiar with the matter. BLOOMBERG

Cabinet approves railway, road infra projects worth ₹12,000 crore

WATER GOVERNANCE. It greenlights extension of Jal Jeevan Mission with an outlay of over ₹5 lakh crore

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) on Tuesday approved infrastructure proposals with an outlay of around ₹12,000 crore. It also gave its nod for the extension of the Jal Jeevan Mission with an outlay of over ₹5 lakh crore. “The Cabinet has approved multitracking projects covering 5 districts of West Bengal and Jharkhand. These projects will enhance efficiency, reduce congestion and strengthen connectivity across these States. They will also improve freight movement, support economic activity and advance sustainable, low-carbon transport,” Prime Minister Narendra Modi said in a social media post related to railway projects.

TOURISM LINKAGES
According to an official state-



INFRA BOOST. Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw at a press briefing on Cabinet decisions, in New Delhi, on Tuesday PTI

ment, the CCEA has approved two railway ministry projects at a cost of about ₹4,474 crore. These include the fourth line on the Sainthia-Pakur and Santragachi-Kharagpur sections. “These multi-tracking proposals are poised to streamline operations and alleviate congestion,” the statement said. The projects covering five districts across West Bengal and Jharkhand will increase

the existing network of the Indian Railways by about 192 km. The project will enhance connectivity to nearly 5,652 villages with a collective population of about 147 lakh. The proposed capacity enhancement will improve rail connectivity to several prominent tourist destinations across the country, including Bolpur-Shantiniketan, Nandikeshwari Temple (Shaktipeeth), Tarapith (Shaktipeeth), Patachitra

Gram, Dhadika forest, Bhimbandh wildlife sanctuary, and Rameshwar Kund, among others, the statement added.

FOUR-LANE CORRIDOR
In another proposal, the CCEA approved the development of a four-lane corridor on the Badnawar-Petlawad-Thandla-Timarwani section of NH-752D, for a length of 80.45 km, at a cost of ₹3,839.42 crore. The corridor will provide connectivity from Ujjain to Timrawani interchange on the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway (DME).

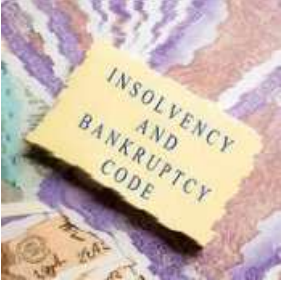
The primary purpose of the proposed four-lane corridor is to improve travel efficiency by reducing travel time by about one hour. The 70.4-km Ujjain-Badnawar section has already been upgraded from two- to four lanes. The Badnawar-Timarwani stretch is an intermediate lane (5.5 m) with poor geometry (speed 20-50 kmph).

The upgradation of the Badnawar-Timarwani section will strengthen inter-State connectivity and enable efficient movement of traffic, besides handling the surge in traffic during the Simhastha Kumbh Mela in April 2028, the statement said.

JAL JEEVAN MISSION
The Cabinet approved a proposal to restructure and reorient the implementation of the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), from infrastructure creation to service delivery, supported by drinking water governance and an institutional ecosystem for sustainable rural piped potable water supply. For restructuring JJM, the Cabinet approved the enhancement of the outlay to ₹8.69 lakh crore, with Central assistance of ₹3.59 lakh crore, which has been enhanced from the ₹2.08 lakh crore approved in 2019-20 — namely an additional Central share of ₹1.51 lakh crore, the statement said.

Revised IBC Bill to be tabled in Budget session

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



The Union Cabinet is believed to have approved a reworked Bill to amend Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC). The Bill will now be tabled in Parliament during the ongoing Budget session. The reworking is based on the recommendations of a parliamentary committee chaired by Baijayant Panda. It suggested further rationalisation of creditor-initiated insolvency, group insolvency and cross-border insolvency frameworks, as also statutory timelines for case disposal by insolvency tribunals. The aim is to speed up admissions, resolution and liquidation, maximise asset value and strengthen governance.

On creditor-initiated insolvency, the committee flagged stakeholder concerns over the enforceability and binding nature of conduct standards for the committee of creditors (CoC). It said prescribing both standards of conduct and decision-making timelines would enhance governance, improve predictability and reinforce the Code’s time-bound resolution objective. It recommended modifying Clause (sa) under Section 196(1) to read: “specify the standards of conduct for the Committee of Creditors and its members, including the period within which the Committee of Creditors shall take decisions.”

STATUTORY TIMELINE
The committee proposed a statutory timeline for appeals, with a new clause mandating that the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal dispose of appeals within three months from the date of receipt. Siddharth Srivastava, Partner at Khaitan & Co, said the introduction of creditor-initiated insolvency resolution process formally acknowledges the role of out-of-court and pre-insolvency solutions in achieving timely resolutions. It provides promoters with greater confidence to pursue revival while avoiding insolvency process.

KEY PROPOSALS
The committee made two key recommendations on cross-border insolvency: amending Section 240C to explicitly require rules to spell out procedures for recognition of proceedings involving specified foreign jurisdictions, as well as mechanisms for relief, judicial cooperation, assistance and coordination; and adding an explanation to

₹ recovers from record low, but risks persist

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl.research bureau



The rupee staged a recovery on Tuesday, gaining about 0.6 per cent to close at 91.81 against the dollar. The domestic currency had slipped to an all-time low of 92.36 on Monday amid heightened global risk aversion. While the bounce back offered some respite, the broader backdrop remains uncertain.

WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.

The dollar has been drawing support from its dual role in global markets. It continues to act as a safe haven during periods of geopolitical stress and the US benefits from higher oil prices due to exports. Geopolitical tensions remain the key driver. The continued strikes by the US and Israel on Iran rattled energy markets, sending crude oil prices sharply higher.

RIISING OIL PRICES
Oil climbed to \$119.50 per

barrel on Monday, the highest since June 2022. Notably, the energy commodity traded above \$100 for the first time since August 2022. Although prices have since cooled to around \$92 per barrel, the initial surge triggered widespread risk aversion across global markets. Even after the pullback, Brent crude remains up by about 50 per cent year-to-date, keeping concerns alive for oil-importing economies like India. Foreign flows have also turned unfavourable. Net FPI outflows totalled about \$3.4 billion over the last week and nearly \$4 billion so

far in March. Weakness in equities has compounded the pressure, with the Nifty 50 down 3.6 per cent in March so far and 7.2 per cent year-to-date. If tensions involving the US, Israel and Iran persist, both equities and the rupee could remain under strain. While the rupee made a record low of 92.36 on Monday, the chart shows that it has largely been oscillating between 91.70 and 92.30 over the last week. However, the broader trend remains bearish. The price action shows that 92.10 offers good support at the moment. If there is a recovery on the back of this, the rupee can inch higher to 91.40 and 91.20. But a recovery beyond the latter is less likely. On the other hand, if the local unit sees a daily close below the support at 92.10, it is in for another downswing, potentially to 92.50 and 92.75. It depends on how the dollar trades. The dollar index, which has been in an uptrend since early February, is now facing

a resistance between 99.15 and 99.70. The price action shows good rejection. Therefore, there is a chance for a corrective decline in the near term, if not a bearish trend reversal. Such a decline can drag the dollar index to 98.30 — a notable support. A breakdown of this can open the door for a decline to 98. In such a scenario, the rupee can rise to 91.40. However, if the dollar index regains strength and moves above 99.70, it can lead to another round of rally, possibly taking it to 100.30. A clear breakout of this barrier can turn the medium-term trend positive for the dollar index, and this could mean fresh lows for the Indian currency. **OUTLOOK**
The near-term bias remains fragile amid geopolitical tensions and dollar strength. As long as the rupee holds above 92.10, it may attempt a recovery towards 91.40. But a breach of 92.10 could push it to 92.50–92.75.

‘Work apace on common empanelment of hospitals’

bl.interview

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

The health insurance sector is expected to clock around 15 per cent year-on-year growth in premiums this fiscal, as both retail and corporate segments are witnessing strong growth, says Mayank Bathwal, member of the Executive Committee, General Insurance Council. Bathwal, CEO of Aditya Birla Health Insurance, says the council is currently working on common empanelment of hospitals and anticipates progress in the next 6-12 months. Common empanelment will facilitate more cashless transactions, he says. Edited excerpts:

What is the expected growth rate for health insurance industry this financial year? What are the growth drivers?
The health insurance industry continues to be the fastest growing segment in the insurance industry today. Both in retail and corporate, in the period up to January, the industry’s growth is around 15 per cent and, as the General Insurance Council has consistently said, this category will continue to grow due to the tailwinds. Penetration is low, and medical inflation is high. People’s awareness of the category has grown significantly since the pandemic.

As more product innovation comes in, newer categories of healthcare expenses and customers emerge, the category will continue to grow ahead of others

MAYANK BATHWAL,
Member of the Executive Committee, General Insurance Council



I would say 15-18 per cent. And if we can open up a newer category... there are conversations underway for the “missing middle” (the customer segment that is not affluent and not covered by government schemes). Many companies have launched products for the segment... many are experimenting. The new chairman [Ajay Seth] is nudging us to do something about the missing middle. And if we can use large platforms like Bima Sugam and other public infrastructure, I am hopeful that growth will continue to exceed 15 per cent.

How far has the common empanelment of hospitals progressed?
For the common empanelment of healthcare providers, the General Insurance Council is having regular dialogues with the healthcare ecosystem to sort out gaps in understanding, because, ultimately, we are all here for the same purpose

— to provide patients the right experience. Recently, we hired industry veteran S Prakash as CEO - Health Insurance Ecosystem and Strategic Partnerships of the General Insurance Council. He is setting up a team to create common empanelment. Any hospital on the panel will have access to all insurance companies. It does not have to negotiate rates with individual insurance companies. Similarly, health insurers need not tie up with different hospitals. The process becomes efficient. Over 6-12 months, we will see significant progress. **Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman recently told banks to stop mis-selling financial products, including insurance. Earlier, the RBI issued draft guidelines on this. What is your view?**
At least for health insurance, miss-selling is not an issue. Complaints generally concern consumers not having had the right experience at the claim stage. So the health insurance industry has to address this issue. The new master circular for policy or protection brought changes in how claims are being managed. We have seen positive traction. We are working with hospitals where there is friction in the cashless experience. With common hospital empanelment, we can adopt more cashless processes and, in turn, address the issue.

Enterprise Connect

Business Initiative

LIC Eastern Zone donates School Bus and additional one floor at School @ Tripura

On the auspicious occasion of Doljatra and Holi LIC donated one school bus to Pranabananda vidyamandir, Khowai, Tripura and donated one floor of school building of Hari Radha vidya mandir, Teliamura, Tripura under its CSR initiative under its GOLDEN JUBILEE celebration. On this occasion Sri Saumitra Kumar De, Regional Manager corporate communication visited both the places and handed over the key to the school authorities and inaugurated the projects.

Kristu Jayanti University signs MOU with IBM

Kristu Jayanti (Deemed to be University) has signed a strategic Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the IBM Innovation Centre for Education and Trans Neuron to launch two industry-integrated undergraduate programmes B.Sc. in Quantum Computing and B.Sc. in Blockchain Technology. This collaboration with IBM equips students to become future-ready professionals through a curriculum co-designed with industry experts and hands-on exposure to emerging technologies. Access to the IBM ICE learning ecosystem, tools, and Quantum Lab enhances employability in next-generation tech roles, while opportunities for internships, projects, certifications, gain practical experience across key Quantum Computing verticals such as quantum algorithms, quantum circuits, quantum cryptography, quantum machine learning, and quantum hardware fundamentals, along with Blockchain technologies including smart contracts, decentralized applications (DApps), Hyperledger, Ethereum, and Web3 architectures and strong research and innovation pathways support the honing of skills for future-ready professionals. The initiative was launched under the guidance of Fr. Dr. Augustine George, Vice Chancellor; Fr. Dr. Lijo P. Thomas, Pro Vice Chancellor; Dr. Aloysius Edward J, Registrar; Dr. Jude Calistus A. L., Dean of Academic; and Dr. R. Kumar, Dean -School of Computational and Physical Sciences, in the presence of IBM representatives Mr. Jagadisha Bhat, Mr. Vigaruddin Surki, Ms. Jayshree Padmanabhan, and Ms. Deeksha Nandekar.,

AceCloud introduces NVIDIA RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell Server Edition GPUs in India

AceCloud, India's leading cloud infrastructure provider, announced the launch of NVIDIA RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell Server Edition GPUs on its cloud platform. With this move, the company becomes one of the first few cloud service providers in India to offer NVIDIA's latest generation GPUs for advanced compute, visualization, and AI workloads. The GPUs are now available to customers across India and the US, with deployments enabled from AceCloud's cloud regions in Noida, Mumbai, and Atlanta. With the addition of NVIDIA RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell Server Edition GPUs, AceCloud is expanding its GPU portfolio to support high-performance AI, graphics-intensive workloads, and low-latency applications. These capabilities are particularly relevant for use cases such as AI model development, medical imaging, real-time rendering, video processing, financial risk analysis, and engineering simulations, serving customers across sectors including healthcare, media and entertainment, financial services, engineering, and automotive.

The College of Horticulture, Durgapura-Jaipur, in collaboration with JNU CONDUCTED Training Program

The College of Horticulture, Durgapura-Jaipur, in collaboration with Linguistic Empowerment Cell, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, organized a One-week Training Program on 'From Curriculum to Career: Communication Skills for Professional Success' from 18-24th February, 2026. Prof. Pushpendra Singh Chauhan, Hon'ble Vice Chancellor, SKNANU Jobner, graced the inaugural ceremony as chief guest on February 18, 2026. Prof. Rakesh Sammauria, Director Education, SKANU Jobner, was the Guest of honour and Prof. R S Meena, Dean, College of Agriculture, Jhilai, was the Special guest on the valedictory session on February 24, 2026. Professor Vaishna Narang, Former Professor of Linguistics & Dean, JNU Delhi and Prof. Pradeep Kumar Das, Professor of Linguistics, JNU Delhi were the keynote speakers for inaugural and valedictory session. During the program, interactive sessions on topics like resume writing, group discussion, job interviews, debate, extempore, public speaking and overcoming fear, leadership and interpersonal skills, presentation skills, expectations of potential employers and communication at workplace etc. were conducted. Prof. L N Baiirwa, Dean, College of Horticulture, informed that more than 100 students of BSc (hons.) Horticulture participated in this program and benefited from it. This one-week training program will not only enhance the confidence and employability skills of students, but also improve their communication skills and help in personality development.

USTM Celebrates National Science Day 2026 with Workshops, Competitions, and Scientific Activities

The University of Science & Technology Meghalaya (USTM) celebrated National Science Day 2026 through a series of academic and interactive programmes aimed at promoting scientific awareness, research aptitude, and innovation among students. Marking the occasion, the Department of Chemistry, USTM, in collaboration with the Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC), organised a workshop on "Research Methodology in Chemistry: Concepts, Tools, and Best Practices." The workshop featured Prof. Pranjal Saikia of Gauhati University as the distinguished resource person. During the session, Prof. Saikia elaborated on fundamental concepts of scientific research, modern analytical tools, and effective research methodologies essential for academic and experimental excellence. The Department of Applied Biology also commemorated National Science Day at the E-Block Smart Room in the presence of faculty members, students. The celebration included a speech competition along with engaging science-based activities such as an inertia challenge and a balance game, encouraging experiential learning and scientific thinking among participants. The programme concluded with a prize distribution ceremony, during which winners of various competitions were awarded 1st, 2nd, and 3rd prizes, along with certificates of appreciation. The celebrations successfully combined academic learning with interactive participation, fostering curiosity, creativity, and enthusiasm for science among students. The observance of National Science Day at USTM reaffirmed the University's commitment to promoting scientific temper, research culture, and innovation-driven education aligned with national development goals.

QUICKLY.

Air Canada to boost Delhi flights till April-end

Mumbai: Air Canada is doubling its frequency on the Toronto-Delhi route till April-end to cater to high passenger demand. It announced it will fly twice daily on the route in view of the capacity constraint caused by West Asia conflict. The conflict in West Asia has disrupted travel plans of travellers globally as Dubai, Doha and Abu Dhabi function as key aviation hubs. Airlines are trying clear the extra rush by deploying additional flights to major destinations. While Air India is operating extra flights to Europe and the US, Air France too is operating two extra services from Paris to Delhi and Mumbai next week. **OUR BUREAU**

Bharti Telecom's share capital reduction upheld

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Tuesday dismissed a batch of appeals filed by minority shareholders of Bharti Telecom Limited (BTL), upholding the company's decision to reduce its share capital and ease out individual investors. A bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and K Vinod Chandran said that the valuation of shares is an expert exercise, and that the company had followed the due process of law under the Companies Act provision.**PTI**

LPG supply worries fuel rush for induction stoves

**Sindhu Hariharan
Rohan Das
Chennai**

With the war in West Asia posing a threat to the supply of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) for household consumption, Indians have begun to purchase induction cooktops as an alternative. Speaking to *businessline*, quick and e-commerce platforms and retailers report a significant increase in sales of induction cooktops along with other electrical cooking utensils. Rajendra Gandhi, MD of Stovekraft that manufactures the Pigeon brand of kitchenware, said they had seen a four-fold spike in the average weekly sales of induction cooktops on e-commerce

RBI issues fresh dividend payout guidelines for commercial banks

NEW FRAMEWORK. Regulator links payouts to capital strength and adjusted profit after tax ratios

**Our Bureau
Mumbai**

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday issued revised prudential directions linking dividend payouts by commercial banks to their CET (common equity tier) 1 capital ratios, replacing guidelines issued as recently as November 2025. The new framework, the Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks – Prudential Norms on Declaration of Dividend and Remittances of Profits) Directions, 2026, takes effect from FY27. Under the revised rules, dividend payouts are structured across 10 capital-ratio buckets. Banks with a CET1 ratio at or below 8 per cent are barred from paying any dividend. Those in the highest bracket — CET1 above 20 per cent — may pay up to 100 per cent of their adjusted profit after tax (PAT). Regardless of which bucket a bank falls in, total dividend in aggregate cannot exceed 75 per cent of PAT for the period.



PRUDENT MOVE. The new regulations will take effect from FY27

One of the notable features of the framework is the concept of “adjusted PAT”, defined as net profit minus 50 per cent of net non-performing assets as of March 31 of the relevant financial year. **BAD LOAN BURDEN** This effectively penalises banks with higher bad loan burden by reducing the base on which permissible di-

vidends are calculated. Domestically systemically important banks (D-SIBs) face additional constraints, as their applicable D-SIB capital buffer is added to each bucket threshold, making it harder to qualify for higher payout ratios. To be eligible to declare dividends, banks must also be compliant with regulatory capital requirement before and after the dividend pay-

ment, carry a positive adjusted PAT, and face no existing RBI restrictions on distributions. **ASSET CLASSIFICATION** A bank's board of directors while considering the proposal for declaration of dividend or remittance of profit of a bank has to consider factors such as the divergence in asset classification and provisioning for

non-performing assets (NPAs), including its trend, as observed if any, under supervisory findings of the Reserve Bank; and auditors’ report to the financial statements, including modified opinion or emphasis of matter, for the financial year for which the dividend is proposed. Further, the board also needs to take into account the current and projected capital position vis-a-vis applicable regulatory capital requirement; and long term growth plans. Foreign banks operating in India through branches may remit net profits to their head offices without prior RBI approval, provided accounts are audited. However, exceptional or extraordinary income, profits overstated per auditor findings, and unrealised gains on level 3 financial instruments are excluded from remittable profits. Banks must report dividend payments or profit remittances to RBI's Department of Supervision within a fortnight of the declaration. Non-compliance may attract supervisory or enforcement action.

Epson India sees textile and label printing contributing 10-12% of revenue in 3-4 years

**Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru**

Epson India is recalibrating and betting on its newer industrial printing segments — textile and labelling — to drive the next phase of growth in the country, with the company expecting these businesses to contribute a meaningful share of revenue over the next few years. Samba Moorthy, President, Epson India, told *businessline* that the segment, though currently small, has been expanding rapidly. “The potential for textile and label printing in India is phenomenal. Over the next three to four years, we expect the segment to continue growing at over 30-40 per



Samba Moorthy, President, Epson India

cent annually. While it is coming off a low base, it could contribute close to 10-12 per cent of Epson India's overall revenue,” Moorthy said. Epson India reported revenue of about ₹2,500 crore last year, and the company expects steady growth over

the next few years, driven by demand across consumer, enterprise and industrial segments. “Our growth over the past four to five years on a CAGR basis is in excess of 7-8 per cent,” Moorthy said. “We aspire to grow at around 12 per cent in the next three years as part of our mid-term growth plan.” **EXPANSION PLAN** The company is also expanding its presence in industrial printing applications such as textile, labelling and signage, areas where digital printing adoption remains relatively low. “Digital printing adoption in textiles is still around 5-6 per cent or less than 10 per cent at this stage, which rep-

resents a significant opportunity,” he said. Epson is positioning its digital textile printing technology as an alternative to conventional rotary printing processes, which tend to involve higher water usage and chemical waste. **STRONG TRACTION** Alongside industrial printing, Epson continues to see strong traction in its core printing business. Its Eco-Tank printers, ink tank printers using continuous ink supply systems, remain a major revenue driver for the company. Moorthy said that Epson currently holds more than 50 per cent market share in the EcoTank printer category in India.

Hybrid super-credits could distort CAFE-III emission targets, warns ex-NITI Aayog official

bl.interview

**Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai**

“If CAFE-III allows inflated hybrid credits and small-car exemptions, manufacturers could meet targets on paper while delaying real investment in electric vehicles. A strong hybrid is fundamentally a petrol vehicle. Giving it credits close to an EV under CAFE-III is regulatory fiction,” said Randheer Singh, former NITI Aayog EV programme head. Singh, now CEO and Founder of ForeSee Advisors, warned that India's proposed Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE-III) norms, currently under review by the Prime Minister's Office, must avoid regulatory distortions that allow manufacturers to meet accelerating genuine electrification. *Edited excerpts:* **What are the key concerns around the current CAFE III debate?** CAFE norms regulate the fleet-average CO₂ emissions across every passenger vehicle a manufacturer sells. In 2017, CAFE-I set the target at 130 g/km, which was tightened to 113 g/km under CAFE-II. The proposed CAFE-III norms would reduce this to roughly 91.7 g/km from April 2027, with further tightening to about 3.01 litres per 100

Introducing a weight-based exemption would create perverse incentives. Automakers have warned that such concessions could create incentives to compromise crash performance **RANDHEER SINGH** former NITI Aayog EV programme head km by FY32 — a 19 per cent reduction from CAFE-II. The debate has become contentious because of two provisions in successive drafts. First, a proposal to grant a special compliance waiver to cars under 909 kg — a segment where one manufacturer accounts for nearly 95 per cent of sales. Second is the super-credit and carbon-neutrality factor structure for hybrids and flex-fuel vehicles, which, on paper, brings their compliance numbers close to those of EVs even though their real-world emissions are three to four times higher. Both provisions distort what CAFE is meant to do — push the entire fleet towards genuine decarbonisation. **What are the concerns around hybrid credits?** A strong hybrid is essentially a petrol vehicle with an electric assist motor. It still burns petrol and produces tailpipe CO₂ emissions, typically 80-100 g/km in real-world conditions. Yet the



current draft provides a 2x super-credit for strong hybrids. If the vehicle is also flex-fuel compatible, it can stack a 2.5x multiplier along with a 22.3 per cent carbon neutrality factor, bringing its paper compliance close to that of a battery-electric vehicle. India's broader policy direction, including PM E-DRIVE, the ₹18,100-crore PLI scheme for advanced chemistry cells, and the target of 30 per cent EV penetration by 2030, clearly points towards electrification. CAFE-III should align with that trajectory. **Should there be a special policy framework for small cars?** Introducing a weight-based exemption would create perverse incentives. Manufacturers could reduce vehicle mass not through advanced materials but by removing structural content, thinner sheet metal, or fewer reinforcements,

which could affect crash-safety. That would contradict the direction India is moving with Bharat NCAP, which aims to improve crash safety standards. India already records over 1.7 lakh road fatalities annually, so safety cannot be compromised. Several automakers, including Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra, have warned that such concessions could create incentives to compromise crash performance, while JSW MG has described the proposal as a competitive distortion. Globally, regulators do not provide blanket exemptions for small cars. The US uses a footprint-based curve, Japan uses step-wise weight bands, and the EU and China follow graduated compliance curves. **The January 2026 draft removed the explicit waiver. Does that solve the issue?** It is an improvement, but not sufficient. The Bureau of Energy Efficiency flattened the compliance slope and shifted the reference weight to 1,229 kg, effectively giving a 909 kg vehicle about 4.5-5.3 g/km of additional relief compared with the earlier formula. However, the structure still relies on a single linear regression, which cannot fully capture the non-linear cost curve of CO₂ abatement. Ideally, the framework should move towards a piecewise-linear or polynomial function that applies uniformly across weight classes, without thresholds or exemptions.

Women bolster Cashify's premium smartphone resale, driving user growth

**Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai**



Nakul Kumar, Co-founder, Cashify

Cashify re-commerce platform reported a 17 per cent annual growth in women subscribers with over 41 lakh women users engaged between August and February. This is double the growth percentage of men on the platform at 9 per cent. “Women users on Cashify are growing nearly twice as fast as men, with a clear tilt towards premium devices and high-value resale. This signals a shift from passive ownership to active lifecycle management. That said, women still account for under one-fifth of our total user base, which means there is significant room for progress,” said Nakul Kumar, Co-Founder, Cashify. When asked, Kumar told *businessline* that the growth is led by confidence among women not to depend on the patriarch of the house to make the device purchase but to make financial decisions on their own. “Security played another important role, as women felt it was safe to sell their old devices, which may contain personal information, at the point of sale. Maybe we have reached an inflection point where the women are feeling safe to do these kinds of transactions. What we realised is that trust is one of the major issues, especially in terms of phone number and device misuse,” said Kumar.

RESEAL TREND Still, data showed that women are now increasingly driving premium transactions and participating in high-value resale cycles. Cashify attributed this to financial maturity and growing awareness about product lifecycles. It argued that commerce is becoming a smart

financial decision, for women selling relatively newer models while continuing to buy within premium segments indicates strong awareness of resale timing, long-term value, and overall device lifecycle management. **APPLE LEADS** Apple accounts for 34 per cent of the phones women buy on Cashify. Top resale models include the iPhone 15 and 16 series, while older models such as the iPhone 6 and iPhone 11 remain popular purchases, indicating interest in entering premium ecosystems across multiple price points. Apple and Samsung together account for the largest share of purchases. The presence of flagship and pro variants further reflects a premium skew in buying behaviour. In terms of resale, Apple accounts for 43 per cent of phones sold to women, including flagship models like the iPhone 16 Pro, 17 Pro Max, and 15 Pro. Nearly 48 per cent of women users are concentrated across the top 10 cities, with Delhi as the largest contributor, followed by Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Mumbai and Pune. Outside metro cities, there is significant participation in Patna, Lucknow, Jaipur and Ahmedabad.

COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED

CIAL/ELE/419

TENDER NOTICE

11/03/2026

Sealed item rate tenders are invited from the reputed OEMs or their authorized channel partners for the work mentioned below at Cochin International Airport, Nedumbassery, Kerala, India.

Name of Work	Estimate Amount (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Completion Period
Revamping of Terminal 3 Aerobridge Canopy at Apron-2 of CIAL	200 Lakhs	4 Lakhs	8 Months

Interested firms have to submit their application forms for pre qualification along with the necessary supporting documents mentioned in the eligibility criteria to the office of the Managing Director, Cochin International Airport Ltd., Kochi Airport P O, Pin: 683 111, on or before 25.03.2026. For details, visit our website: www.cial.aero

MANAGING DIRECTOR

TATA

TATA POWER

(Corporate Contracts Department)

The Tata Power Company Limited, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station
Sahar Airport Road, Andheri East, Mumbai-400059
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tenders from eligible vendors for the following package (Two Part Bidding) in Mumbai.
A) Corrigendum 2_NIT_EPC of SITC of 220kV GIS bays along with the PAC & other Auxiliaries at MSETCL Bhandup Substation for LILO at 220kV Kalwa Salsette-5 Line (Package Ref: CC26ASM003)
Interested & eligible bidders for above package to submit Tender Fee, Authorization Letter before 15:00 Hrs. **Wednesday, 18th March 2026**.
For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Also, all future corrigendum's if any, to the said tender will be published on Tender section of above website (Tata Power → Business Associates → Tender Documents) only.

TATA

TATA POWER

(Corporate Contracts Department)

The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 3rd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai-400059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding) in Mumbai.
(A) Outline Agreement of 1 year for Services of Control Cable Removal at Trombay RSS. (Package Ref: CC26NK040).
Interested and eligible bidders to submit Tender Fee and Authorization Letter before 1500 hrs. **Wednesday, 11th March 2026**.
For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Also, all future corrigendum's if any, to the said tender will be published on Tender section of above website (Tata Power → Business Associates → Tender Documents) only.

MPL

MAITHON POWER LIMITED

(Contracts Department)

Maithon Power Ltd, Village: Dambhui, PO Barindia, PIN-828205, District-Dhanbad

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Maithon Power Limited, a joint venture between Tata Power and DVC invites expression of interest from eligible vendors for the following packages

S.No.	Ref.No	Package Description
1	1000077484	Supply of RAPD Baskets at MPL
2	1500020424	Supply of Erosion Protection Shield at MPL
3	1000077404	Supply of Washer Punched A24 for AUX L-Drive Unit at MPL
4	2000092595	U#2 AOH Electrical Support Services at MPL
5	1500020617	Supply of Vibration Analyser with Spectrum Analysis at MPL
6	2500022977	Fabrication and erection of LTSH Coil handling platform for U#2 and U#1

For details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc., please visit our website URL- <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>
Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **25th Mar'26**.

QUICKLY.

Aluminium down after Trump's comments



Aluminium steadied on Tuesday after US President Donald Trump's pledge of a rapid conclusion to the Middle East war eased supply concerns and triggered profit taking. Benchmark three-month aluminium on the LME nudged up 0.1 per cent at \$3,388 per tonne. Zinc was the biggest gainer, climbing 1.1 per cent to \$3,364. REUTERS

Gold gains on softer \$, cooling inflation concerns

Gold rose buoyed by a pause in the dollar's rally and easing inflation concerns. Spot gold was up 1.2 per cent at \$5,200.29 per ounce as of 1311 GMT. US gold futures for April delivery were up 2.1 per cent at \$5,210.70. Silver rose 2.4 per cent to \$89.21. Platinum gained 2.1 per cent at \$2,228.35, while palladium added 0.2 per cent at \$1,693.70. REUTERS

Crude oil slips on US' de-escalation signals



London: Crude oil prices plummeted 7 per cent as US President Trump predicted that the war in the Middle East could end soon, easing concerns about prolonged disruptions to supplies. Brent futures were down \$7.15 at \$91.81 a barrel by 1307 GMT, while US WTI crude was down \$6.26 at \$88.51 a barrel. REUTERS

Foodgrain output pegged 3% up at 349 mt in 2025-26

BOUNTIFUL HARVEST. Record high output of wheat, maize and mustard crops projected for rabi; kharif harvest estimates of sugarcane and rice raised

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

India will likely harvest record wheat, maize (corn) and mustard crops during the current season, while sugarcane harvest has also been estimated at a record during the current crop year to June.

Rice production is also headed for a record high after kharif output has been projected at a new high.

The country is estimated to have produced a record high 120.21 million tonnes (mt) of wheat, 11.79 mt of gram (*chana*) against 11.11 mt a year ago, 1.73 mt of lentils against 1.65 mt a year ago and 13.33 mt of mustard against 12.66 mt a year ago, according to the govern-

ment's second advance estimates of crops) released on Tuesday.

Wheat production is up 2 per cent from the previous high of 117.94 mt in 2024-25, government data showed on Tuesday. A flour industry source said production will easily top 121 million tonnes as everything had rolled out in favour of a good crop.

PULSES TO GROW 7%

Total foodgrain production of both the kharif and rabi seasons is estimated to rise 3 per cent to 348.65 mt in 2025-26 from 338.63 mt a year earlier, the Agriculture Ministry said in a statement.

The second advance estimate includes the first estimate of rabi crops and revised estimate of kharif crops. Pulses output is pro-



NEW HIGH. Wheat production is up 2 per cent from the previous high of 117.94 mt in 2024-25. An industry source said output will easily top 121 mt

jected to grow 7 per cent to 16.24 mt in the rabi season of 2025-26 from 15.23 mt a year ago, potentially helping India to cut the demand-supply

gap as well as imports.

OILSEEDS MIXED

However, winter-grown urad output is seen lower at

5,08,000 tonnes from 5,53,000 tonnes, and green gram (moong) at 87,000 tonnes from 1,00,000 tonnes. Winter-sown

30% cut in natural gas supply to fertilizer firms may affect urea output

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The Union government on Tuesday informed Parliament that urea sales in the current rabi season (October-March) stood at 186.33 lakh tonnes (lt) as of March 5, exceeding the demand estimate of 183.51 lt for the period, leaving a stock of 49.01 lt.

However, with the government announcing a 30 per cent cut in natural gas supply — the key feedstock for urea production — there are concerns that the opening stock of the nitrogen fertilizer on April 1 may be lower, unless supplemented through imports.

The demand estimate for March alone is 14.95 lt. As of



had imported 98 lt of urea, with another 17 lt scheduled over the next three months.

MAY HIT OUTPUT

Domestic urea production in March 2025 stood at 24.78 lt, but following the decision to supply only 70 per cent of normal gas allocation, output could fall to around 18 lt, according to an industry expert.

On March 9, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas issued an order under the Essential Commodities Act to regulate the production, allocation and distribution of natural gas, including LNG and regasified LNG.

Under the order, the fertilizer sector will receive second priority in gas allocation, after LPG and PNG used for cooking and CNG

used for transport.

Replying to a question in the Rajya Sabha, Chemicals and Fertilizers Minister Jagat Prakash Nadra said the supply position for di-ammonium phosphate (DAP), muriate of potash (MOP) and complex fertilizers is comfortable due to lower-than-expected sales.

OTHER FERTILIZERS

DAP sales during October 1, 2025-March 5, 2026, were 50.28 lt, against the demand estimate of 51.38 lt, leaving a stock of 21.61 lt.

MOP sales stood at 10.18 lt against demand of 14.18 lt, while complex fertilizer sales were 62.90 lt against demand of 76.48 lt.

Stocks as of March 5 were 8 lt for MOP and 45.51 lt for complex fertilizers.

Mauritius market opens for Maharashtra onions

Our Bureau
Pune

Maharashtra is set to expand its onion export footprint, with more than one lakh tonnes from Nashik and Ahmednagar districts expected to be shipped to Mauritius, State Marketing Minister Jaykumar Raval informed the Legislative Council on Tuesday.

Replying to a question by MLC Sachin Ahir on the hunger strike by onion farmers in Chandwad, Raval said the move is part of efforts to identify new export destinations as traditional markets face rising competition.

INTENSE COMPETITION

Rawal noted that Sri Lanka and Bangladesh, once major markets for Indian onions,

Production of kharif & rabi crops (in million tonnes)			
	2024-25	2025-26	% Change
Rice	138.90	140.65	1.3
Wheat	117.94	120.21	1.9
Pulses	22.96	23.87	4.0
Oilseeds	41.66	41.00	-1.6
Maize	39.56	46.15	16.7
Nutri Cereals	17.34	15.44	-11.0
*Cotton	29.72	29.09	-2.1
Sugarcane	454.61	500.20	10.0
Total foodgrains	338.63	348.65	3.0

Source: Agriculture Ministry *in million bales of 170 kg each

groundnut output is seen higher at 7,97,000 tonnes from 6,78,000 tonnes, but sunflower production is estimated lower at 1,04,000 tonnes from 1,21,000 tonnes.

MAIZE, RICE OUTPUT

Despite lower price realisation, farmers have increased output of rabi maize to 15.9

mt from 14.75 mt, while rabi rice production is estimated slightly higher at 16.72 mt against 16.12 mt. Coarse and nutri cereals output is pegged at 21.34 mt, up from 19.86 mt a year ago. The rabi crop production is based on the average yield and is subject to change in the successive estimates, the Agriculture Ministry said.



EYEING NEW MARKETS. The State is planning to ship more than 1 lakh tonnes of the bulb from Nashik and Ahmednagar

had ramped up domestic production in recent years, intensifying competition in the global trade.

Against this backdrop, exploring newer markets such as Mauritius has become necessary, he said.

Maharashtra continues to dominate India's onion exports, accounting for around

80 per cent of the country's shipments. Within the State, Nashik district contributes nearly 70-80 per cent of Maharashtra's onion exports.

Lasalgaon in Nashik — Asia's largest onion market — serves as the key hub for onion trading and exports, playing a central role in the State's supply chain.

February 2026 was 5th warmest month on record

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

February 2026 was the fifth warmest month on record, with temperatures reaching 1.49°C above pre-industrial levels, according to the Copernicus Climate Change Service, implemented by the European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF).

The month witnessed intense storms and unusually heavy rainfall, triggering severe flooding across parts of western Europe, while the Arctic sea ice extent dropped to the third-lowest level on record for February.

The month was marked by a series of intense storms and heavy precipitation, particularly across western Europe and northern Africa. France, Spain, Portugal and Morocco recorded exceptionally wet conditions, resulting in severe flooding in several regions.

Global average surface

temperature was 13.26°C, 0.53°C higher than the 1991-2020

February average

February also witnessed flooding events elsewhere, including in Australia, Mozambique and Botswana.

CLIMATE CHANGE IMPACT

Samantha Burgess, Strategic Lead for Climate at ECMWF, said, "The extreme events of February 2026 highlight the growing impacts of climate change and the pressing need for global action. With global temperatures reaching 1.49°C above pre-industrial levels — the fifth-warmest February on record — Europe experienced stark temperature contrasts. Exceptional atmospheric rivers

— narrow bands of very moist air — brought record rainfall and widespread flooding to western and southern Europe, while Arctic sea ice extent ranked as the third-lowest for the month."

February 2026 ranked as the fifth-warmest February globally, with an average surface air temperature of 13.26°C, according to the ERA5 dataset.

This was 0.53°C higher than the 1991-2020 February average and 1.49°C above the estimated 1850-1900 pre-industrial level. The warmest February on record continues to be 2024. In Europe, the average land temperature during February 2026 was -0.07°C, about 0.10°C lower than the 1991-2020 average, making it one of the three coldest Februaries recorded across the continent in the past 14 years.

The continent experienced sharp regional contrasts, with warmer-than-average

conditions across western, southern, and south-eastern Europe, whereas Fennoscandia, the Baltic States, and north-west Russia recorded colder-than-average conditions.

Outside Europe, temperatures were above the average across the US, north-east Canada, West Asia, Central Asia and East Antarctica. Colder conditions were seen in Alaska, northern Canada, Greenland and northern Russia, showing the clear regional contrasts in temperature patterns.

For the boreal winter from December 2025 to February 2026, the global average temperature was the fifth highest recorded, at 0.51°C above the 1991-2020 average. In Europe, the winter was among the two coldest in the past 13 years, at 0.09°C above the long-term average, reflecting the sharp regional contrasts in temperature and precipitation observed during February.

Centre to allow DDGS import from the US at lower duty, but volume will be curbed

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The Union government has considered tariff concession for imports of animal feed DDGS (dried distillers grains with solubles) from the US under a quota in its deal with Washington but the volume will be restricted, according to Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Union Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying.

In a written reply to a question in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday on whether the government had given permission to the import of animal feed DDGS and other grains from the US, he said that in the backdrop of growing demand for animal feed in the country, DDGS had been considered for tariff concessions within a quota.

This means that a limited



quantity will be permitted to be imported with tariff concession, much like the tariff rate quota for some commodities such as corn.

The Minister said there would be no adverse impact on the market for domestically grown feed crops due to this.

India and the US announced a trade deal on February 2. A joint statement on

Buy aluminium futures if the price dips to ₹331

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

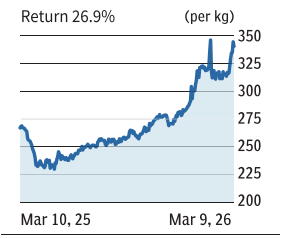
Aluminium futures are now trading at ₹333 per kg. Over the last week, it saw a sharp rally to hit a high of ₹350.90 before moderating to the current price.

The price action shows that the support at ₹328 is stopping the decline. That said whether aluminium futures will see another round of a swift upswing is uncertain. Nevertheless, the price is likely to retest the ₹345-350 band.

COMMODITY CALL.

If the bulls gather enough strength to break out of the barrier at ₹350, the contract could rally to ₹375.

If the support at ₹328 is breached, aluminium futures



could drop to the ₹320-318 support region. Notably, the 21- and 50-day moving average coincides at ₹318, making it a strong base. Thus, there could be a rebound on the back of this.

In case the support at ₹318 is breached, the contract could extend the decline to ₹307.

TRADE STRATEGY

Traders could consider short-term buys if the price softens to ₹331. Target and stop-loss can be ₹345 and ₹323, respectively.

‘India becoming tech ambitious agri-insurance market’

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

India is becoming the most technologically ambitious agri-insurance market globally with the landscape transitioning from scale-first to intelligence-led coverage, according to Navin Sharma, Senior Leader from EDME Insurance Brokers Ltd.

"India today operates the largest crop insurance ecosystem globally by farmer count, anchored by the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY). The evolution is no longer about onboarding farmers alone; it is about precision, credibility and sustainability," he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

EDME Insurance Brokers Ltd, one of India's leading insurance and reinsurance broking firms, was launched in 2024 through the acquisition of Aditya Birla Insurance Brokers Ltd and the integra-



India operates the largest crop insurance ecosystem globally by farmer count, anchored by PM Fasal Bima Yojana

NAVIN SHARMA

Senior Leader, EDME Insurance Brokers Ltd



tion of UIB India. Mumbai-based EDME, recognised for its technology-led approach, is backed by prominent investors, including Samara Capital, Norwest Venture Partners and Creador.

EDME has built a strong pan-India presence with 19 branches and a team of over 350 professionals, serving clients across more than 1,600 cities. In FY25, the firm managed a premium book exceeding ₹5,000 crore, working

lines. The agri-insurance sector is shifting from manual, area-based assessments to satellite, artificial intelligence and model-based yield estimation. Reactive claim settlement has moved to predictive and near real-time payouts through public-private-technology partnerships, Sharma said.

While Western agri-insurance systems are farmer- and revenue-centric, offering farm-level yield and price protection, the Indian system remains climate- and yield-centric with area-based risk pooling. "However, India is leapfrogging by embedding satellite intelligence and digital public infrastructure at a national scale, something Western markets adopted gradually over decades," Sharma said.

On the role of satellites in crop insurance and claims, he said satellite intelligence had become foundational, not experimental.

‘AI platform cuts food loss, boosts farmer payments’

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

FarMart, an AI-native agri food and energy value chain platform, has released its 2025 Impact Report, outlining measurable environmental, economic and governance outcomes across India's agri food and energy value chains.

The report maps how operational innovation across sourcing, logistics and commerce is helping reduce food loss, strengthen farmer incomes and improve transparency.

EFFICIENT SYSTEM

Quoting Alekh Sanghera, Co-founder and CEO of FarMart, a media statement said India's food system doesn't break at the farm; it breaks due to coordination issues. Small inefficiencies across ag-

gregation, logistics, storage and payment cycles compound into food loss, emissions and income volatility.

"Our focus has been to redesign that middle layer using technology, data and disciplined execution. The emissions avoided and food loss prevented this year are not parallel sustainability initiatives; they are operational outcomes of building a more efficient system," Sanghera said.

Operating across more than 40 agricultural products and engaging over 4.87 lakh farmers, FarMart said its technology-led supply chain redesign helped avoid 23,567 tonnes of CO₂ emissions, prevent 18,305 tonnes of post-harvest food loss in 2025, and save 5.39 billion litres of freshwater.

Farmers collectively earned over ₹23.4 billion through FarMart during the year.

SC to examine Centre’s plea against HC verdict striking down IT rules

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to examine the Centre’s plea challenging a Bombay High Court verdict that struck down amendments to Information Technology Rules aimed at regulating fake and false content against the government on social media.

The top court did not stay the 2024 High Court verdict, which struck down the amended Information Technology Rules and termed them “unconstitutional”, even as a three-judge bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices R Mahadevan and Joymalya Bagchi issued notices to the



Justice Chandurkar served as the tie-breaker judge after a division bench issued a split verdict on the matter earlier

original petitioners, including stand-up comedian Kunal Kamra, the Editors Guild of India, and the Association of Indian Magazines.

The High Court struck down the rules amended in 2023 to empower the Cent-

ral government to establish a Fact-Check Unit (FCU) to identify “fake, false, or misleading” information regarding “government business” on social media. If the FCU flagged content under those rules, social media interne-

diaries such as X, Facebook, or YouTube would have to take it down or risk losing their safe harbour immunity.

During Tuesday’s hearing, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, representing the Centre, sought a stay on the High Court’s order, arguing that the government did not intend to “block content completely” but rather to regulate misinformation.

The CJI expressed concern over the current state of social media platforms. “The way some of these platforms are behaving nowadays... look at the illustrations placed on record, how dangerously (they operate),” the CJI said, specifically pointing to fake messages concerning the Army and national policies.

Chennai Port-Maduravoyal elevated corridor to be completed by Nov 2027

Our Bureau
Chennai



Virender Sambal, Regional Officer of NHAI

The construction of the 4-lane, double-tier elevated corridor from Chennai Port to Maduravoyal is scheduled for completion by November 2027, said Virender Sambal, Regional Officer of the National Highway Authority of India (NHAI).

Originally initiated in 2010 but terminated in 2016, this project was restarted in 2023 following requests from the Tamil Nadu government and the Chennai Port Trust, guided by a technical committee.

The 20.9-km corridor, being built at a cost of ₹3,500 crore, is uniquely designed with two levels to efficiently segregate different types of traffic, he said in a release.

The project will significantly boost the Chennai port’s cargo handling capacity from the current 53 mil-

lion tonnes per annum to an estimated 200 mtpa by 2047, the release said.

Sambyal said that a massive casting yard, including a 80-acre facility, are being utilised to manufacture over 500 pre-cast concrete bridge segments per month in advance.

To expedite the massive infrastructure work, construction activities at the site are currently progressing for 11 hours a day (5 hours during the daytime and 6 hours at night) with the support of the traffic police, he said.



SRI VARAHA LAKSHMI NARASIMHA SWAMY VARI DEVASTHANAM
SIMHACHALAM VISAKHAPATNAM DISTRICT, A.P. - 530028.
SVLNSD-LEASOC3/1/2026, Dt. Dt. 08-03-2026
PH: 8008129195 / 7396164484, Email :- endow-eosvlnsd@gov.in

E-TENDER CUM PUBLIC AUCTION NOTICE

Advertisement Dt.23.02.2026 given E-Tender -Sealed tender cum public auction for Human Hair schedule to be conducted on 09.03.2026 is cancelled due to technical reasons.

For e-tender schedule and for further details please log on to www.aeprocurement.gov.in (or) <https://tender.aeprocurement.gov.in> Download starting from 10.03.2026 to 11.00 A.M. on 23.03.2026, last date for uploading of bids: 1.00 P.M. on 23.03.2026 and sealed tenders and public auction to be held on 24.03.2026 For further details please contact at Devasthanam Office in working hours.

Sd/- Jallepalli Venkata Rao, Executive Officer

BEFORE THE HONOURABLE DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL I ERNAKULAM
ORIGINAL APPLICATION No. 10 of 2025

State Bank of India, Stressed Assets Recovery Branch II Ernakulam : Applicant
Vs
Tharunkumar R : Defendant

SUMMONS

Whereas, O.A. NO. 10/2025 was listed before the Tribunal on **02.02.2026**
Whereas, this Honble Tribunal is pleased to issue Summons on the said application under Section 19(4) of the Act, filed against you for recovery of debts of **Rs. 25,06,565/-**.
In accordance with Sub - Section (4) of Section 19 of the Act, you, the defendants 4 are directed as under:-
(i) To show cause within thirty days of the service of summons as to why the relief prayed for should not be granted;
(ii) To disclose particulars of properties or assets other than properties and assets specified by the applicant under serial number 3 A of the original application;
(iii) You are restrained from dealing with or disposing of secured assets or such other Assets and properties disclosed under serial number 3A of the original application, pending hearing and disposal of the application for attachment of properties;
(iv) You shall not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise, except in the ordinary course of his business, any of the assets over which security interest is created and / or other assets and properties specified or disclosed under serial number 3A of the original application without the prior approval of the Tribunal;
(v) You shall be liable to account for the sale proceeds realized by the sale of secured assets or other assets and properties in the ordinary course of business and deposit such sale proceeds in the account maintained with the bank or financial institutions holding security interest over such assets.

You are also directed to file the written statement with a copy thereof furnished to the applicant and to appear before the Registrar of this Honble Tribunal on **25.03.2026** at **11.00 a.m** failing which the application shall be heard and decided in your absence.
Given under my hand and seal of this Tribunal on this the 3rd day of March 2026.

Sd/-
By order of the Tribunal Registrar
Debts Recovery Tribunal, Ernakulam

Defendant
Tharun Kumar R S/o Rajkumar No 30/3, Rangabhashyam Street, West Saidapet, Chennai, Tamilnadu 600015



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NOT FOR PUBLICATION, RELEASE OR DISTRIBUTION, DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA.



RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT TRUST

The Trust has been registered in the Republic of India as an irrevocable trust set up under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882, on November 24, 2025, and registered as an infrastructure investment trust under the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Infrastructure Investment Trusts) Regulations, 2014, on December 22, 2025, having registration number IN/InvIT/25-26/0034.

Principal Place of Business: G - 5 & 6, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi – 110 075; Telephone: +91 11 2507 4100/200 - 3211; Compliance Officer: Gunjan Rajpal; E-mail: compliance@riimpl.in; Website: www.raajmarginfrastrust.in

SPONSOR	INVESTMENT MANAGER	TRUSTEE
		 IDBI Trusteeship Services Ltd
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA	RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT MANAGERS PRIVATE LIMITED	IDBI TRUSTEESHIP SERVICES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] UNITS OF RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT TRUST (“TRUST”) FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER UNIT TOGETHER WITH SPONSOR CONTRIBUTION AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 60,000.00 MILLION (“ISSUE”).
THE ISSUE IS AN INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER IN RELIANCE UPON REGULATION 14(4) OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (INFRASTRUCTURE INVESTMENT TRUSTS) REGULATIONS, 2014, AS AMENDED (“INVIT REGULATIONS”).

Price Band: ₹99 to ₹100 per Unit

Bidders (other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors) can make Bids for a minimum of 150 Units and in multiples of 150 Units thereof

Minimum Bid Size for Bidders other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors - ₹14,850

RISKS TO INVESTORS:

- The Trust is a newly settled trust with no operating history and limited historical financial information and, as a result, investors may not be able to assess its prospects on the basis of past records and the financial information disclosed in the Offer Document.
- The Project SPV has not executed the concession for InvIT Assets with the concessioning authority.

- The Trust must maintain certain investment ratios, which may present additional risks to the Trust.
- The ability of the Trust to make or maintain consistency in distributions to Unitholders depends on the financial performance of the Project SPV and their profitability.

Credit Ratings: (i) (a) Provisional CARE AAA; Stable from CARE Ratings Limited for the proposed bank loan facilities aggregating to ₹40,000.00 million to be availed by the Trust; and (b) Provisional CARE AAA; Stable, from CARE Ratings Limited as issuer rating, and (ii) (a) Provisional Ind AAA/Stable from India Ratings & Research Private Limited for the proposed bank loan facilities aggregating to ₹40,000.00 million to be availed by the Trust; and (b) Provisional Ind AAA/Stable as issuer rating from India Ratings & Research Private Limited.

BID ISSUE/PROGRAM	BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY	BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON FRIDAY, MARCH 13, 2026*
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*The Investment Manager may in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, consider closing the Bid/ Issue Period for QIBs one Working Day prior to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, in accordance with the InvIT Regulations.

ASBA[#]	Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!	[#] Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) is a better way of applying to Issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.	Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.
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UPI-Now available in ASBA for Individual Non-Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Individual Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors. UPI may be availed by Individual Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Category. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section “*Issue Information*” on page 271 of the Offer Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of BSE Limited (“BSE”) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (“NSE”), and together with BSE, the “Stock Exchanges”) and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited and HDFC Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Issue, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Issue related queries, please contact the Book Running Lead Managers (“BRLMs”) on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail ID: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

In case of any revision to the Price Band, the Bid/Issue Period will be extended by at least one Working Day, subject to the total Bid/Issue Period not exceeding 30 days, provided that there shall not be more than two revisions to the Price Band during the Bid/Issue Period. Any revision to the Price Band and the revised Bid/Issue Period, if applicable, will be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges during the Bid/Issue Period and by indicating the change on the websites of the Trust, the Sponsor, the Investment Manager, Book Running Lead Managers, Syndicate Members, SCSBs and Stock Exchanges.

In case of force majeure, banking strike or similar circumstances, the Bid/ Issue Period may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, be extended by a minimum period of three Working Days, subject to the total Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 30 days.

This Issue is being made through the Book Building Process and in compliance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular, wherein not more than 75.00% of the Net Issue (excluding the Strategic Investor Portion) shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Institutional Investors, provided that the Investment Manager may, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, allocate up to 60.00% of the Institutional Investor Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular. Further, not less than 25.00% of the Net Issue (excluding the Strategic Investor Portion) shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Non-Institutional Investors, in accordance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. The Issue will also include participation by Strategic Investors, wherein not less than 5.00% of the Net Issue and not more than 25.00% of the Net Issue shall be allocated to the Strategic Investors in accordance with the InvIT Regulations and the SEBI InvIT Master Circular. All Bidders, other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors, are required to utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (in case of individual Non-Institutional Investors using the UPI Mechanism Bidding with a Bid Amount of ₹ 0.50 million or less), in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks (“SCSBs”) or under the UPI Mechanism, as applicable, to participate in this Issue. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, please see the section entitled “*Issue Information*” on page 271 of the Offer Document.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment

Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.

LISTING: The Units to be offered pursuant to the Offer Document are proposed to be listed on the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (the “NSE”) and BSE Limited (the “BSE”, together with NSE, the “**Stock Exchanges**”). In-principle approval for listing of the Units has been received from BSE and NSE pursuant to letters, each dated February 13, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, NSE is the Designated Stock Exchange. The Investment Manager shall apply to the Stock Exchanges for the final listing and trading approval, after the Allotment and the credit of the Units to the demat accounts of the Allottees.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (“SEBI”): It is to be distinctly understood that submission of Offer Document to SEBI should not in any way be deemed or construed that the same has been cleared or approved by SEBI. SEBI does not take any responsibility either for the financial soundness of any scheme or the project for which the Issue is proposed to be made or for the correctness of the statements made or opinions expressed in the Offer Document.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF NSE (the Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document for the full text of the Disclaimer clause of NSE.

DISCLAIMER CLAUSE OF BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document for the full text of the Disclaimer clause of the BSE.

GENERAL RISKS: Investments in Units involve a degree of risk and Bidders should not invest any funds in this Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. For taking an investment decision, Bidders must rely on their own examination of the Trust, the Units and this Issue. Bidders are advised to carefully read the section entitled “*Risk Factors*” on page 42 of the Offer Document before making an investment decision relating to this Issue. Each Bidder is advised to consult its own advisors in respect of the consequences of an investment in the Units being issued pursuant to this Issue. The Offer Document has been prepared by the Trust solely for providing information in connection with this Issue. The Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”) and the Stock Exchanges assume no responsibility for or guarantee the correctness or accuracy or adequacy of any statements made, opinions expressed or reports contained herein. Admission of the Units to be issued pursuant to this Issue for trading on the Stock exchanges should not be taken as an indication of the merits of the Trust or of the Units.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS				REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE
 Complete Investment Banking Solutions			 Investment Banking	 EXPERIENCE TRANSFORMATION
SBI CAPITAL MARKETS LIMITED 1501, 15 th Floor, Axis House, Parinee Crescenzo Building, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4196 8300; E-mail: raajmarg.ipo@sbicaps.com Investor grievance e-mail: investor.relations@sbicaps.com Contact person: Sanjay Sethia Website: www.sbicaps.com SEBI registration number: INM000003531	AXIS CAPITAL LIMITED 1 st Floor, Axis House, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4325 2183 E-mail: raajmarg.ipo@axiscap.in Investor grievance e-mail: complaints@axiscap.com Contact person: Harish Patel/ Mayuri Arya Website: www.axiscapital.co.in SEBI registration number: INM000012029	ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED ICICI Venture House, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 6807 7100 E-mail: raajmarg.ipo@icicisecurities.com Investor grievance e-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com Contact person: Shri Subramanyam / Sumit Singh Website: www.icicisecurities.com SEBI registration number: INM000011179	MOTILAL OSWAL INVESTMENT ADVISORS LIMITED Motilal Oswal Tower, Rahimullah Sayani Road, Opposite Parel ST Depot, Prabhadevi, Mumbai – 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 7193 4380 E-mail: rii.ipo@motilaloswal.com Investor grievance e-mail: moiapredressal@motilaloswal.com Contact person: Shashank Pisat/Sankita Ajinkya Website: www.motilaloswalgroup.com SEBI registration number: INM000011005	KFIN TECHNOLOGIES LIMITED Selenium, Tower B, Plot No-31 and 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad, Rangareddy - 500 032, Telangana, India Tel.: +91 1800 309 4001 / +91 40 6716 2222 E-mail: riimpl.invit@kfintech.com Investor grievance e-mail: einward.rs@kfintech.com Website: www.kfintech.com Contact person: M. Murali Krishna SEBI registration number: INR000000221
CONTACT PERSON AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER				Bidders can contact the Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related problems such as non-receipt of Allotment Advice/ letter of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Units in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders and non-receipt of funds by electronic mode.
Gunjan Rajpal, G - 5 & 6, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi – 110 075; Telephone: +91 11 2507 4100/200 - 3211; E-mail: compliance@riimpl.in				

AVAILABILITY OF THE OFFER DOCUMENT: Investors are advised to refer to the Offer Document and the “*Risk Factors*” beginning on page 42 of the Offer Document before applying in the Issue. A copy of the Offer Document is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and is available on the websites of the Book Running Lead Managers, i.e., www.sbicaps.com and www.axiscapital.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.motilaloswalgroup.com, and the websites of the InvIT at www.raajmarginfrastrust.in and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE at www.bseindia.com and for NSE at www.nseindia.com.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid-cum-Application Forms can be obtained from the principal place of business of Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust, **Telephone:** +91 11 2507 4100/200 - 3211 at the offices of the Book Running Lead Managers: **SBI CAPITAL MARKETS LIMITED, Tel:** +91 22 4196 8300, **AXIS CAPITAL LIMITED, Tel:** +91 22 4325 2183, **ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED, Tel:** +91 22 6807 7100 and **MOTILAL OSWAL INVESTMENT ADVISORS LIMITED, Telephone:** +91 22 7193 4380 and Syndicate Member: Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited and SBICAP Securities Limited and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid-cum-Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-syndicate Members: Alankit Imaginations Limited, Almondz Global Securities Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C. Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt. Limited, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd., G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, IIFL Capital Services Limited, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Jhaveri Securities, JM Financial Services Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chihaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd., Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, Lakshminshree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Ltd., Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Ltd., RR Equity Brokers Pvt. Ltd., Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, SS Corporate Securities Limited, Tanna Financial Services, TradeBulls Securities (P) Limited, Upstox Securities Private Limited, Yes Securities (India) Limited

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors other than Anchor Investors and Strategic Investors, have to apply through the ASBA process. For details on the ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and abridged offer document and also please refer to the section “*Issue Information*” beginning on page 271 of the Offer Document. ASBA Forms can also be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges. ASBA form can be obtained from the list of banks that is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in. ASBA Form can be obtained from Members of the Syndicate, SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs, the list of which is available on the website of SEBI.

ESCROW COLLECTION BANK, REFUND BANK AND SPONSOR BANK: ICICI Bank Limited

PUBLIC ISSUE ACCOUNT BANK AND SPONSOR BANK: HDFC Bank Limited

SPONSOR CONTRIBUTION BANK: Yes Bank Limited

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the Offer Document.

Place: New Delhi
Date: March 10, 2026

RAAJMARG INFRA INVESTMENT TRUST is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offer of its Units and has filed the Offer Document dated February 28, 2026 with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges. The Offer Document is made available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the Book Running Lead Managers i.e., SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.sbicaps.com, Axis Capital Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com and Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswalgroup.com, the website of the NSE at www.nseindia.com and the website of the BSE at www.bseindia.com and the website of the Trust at www.raajmarginfrastrust.in. Any potential investor should note that investment in Units involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risks, please see the section titled “*Risk Factors*” beginning on page 42 of the Offer Document. Potential investors should not rely on the Draft Offer Document for making any investment decision.

The Units have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the “Securities Act”) and may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Units are only being offered and sold outside the United States in “offshore transactions” as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the Securities Act (“Regulation S”) and the applicable law of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales are made.

For Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust
on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Gunjan Rajpal
Compliance Officer

IndiGo CEO Pieter Elbers resigns; Rahul Bhatia to take interim charge

BIG DEPARTURE. Aviation veteran steps down citing personal reasons; Co-founder to oversee ops temporarily

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Airline major InterGlobe Aviation, the parent company of IndiGo, on Tuesday said its Chief Executive Officer Pieter Elbers has resigned with immediate effect.

Elbers, a Dutch aviation veteran and former Chief Executive of KLM Royal Dutch Airlines, had taken over as CEO of IndiGo in September 2022, succeeding Ronojoy Dutta.

During his tenure, he oversaw the airline's international expansion, the roll-out of premium products, placing massive orders for jets and the induction of leased wide-body 787 aircraft as the carrier entered its next phase of growth.

His departure comes months after the airline faced widespread flight disruptions and cancellations across the country that left thousands of passengers

stranded and drew regulatory scrutiny. The episode had fuelled speculation within the aviation sector that Elbers could be on his way out of the airline's top role.

At the time, aviation safety regulator Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) imposed financial penalties amounting to ₹22.20 crore on IndiGo, following an inquiry into large-scale flight disruptions reported last year.

FLIGHT OPERATIONS

Besides, the regulator issued cautions and warnings to several senior officials of InterGlobe Aviation. These included a caution to Elbers for inadequate overall oversight of flight operations and crisis management.

The enforcement action followed an inquiry conducted by a four-member committee constituted by the DGCA after IndiGo reported the cancellation of 2,507 flights and delays to 1,852



BOWING OUT. IndiGo CEO Pieter Elbers

flights between December 3 and 5, 2025. The disruptions affected more than three lakh passengers across the country.

It is understood that Elbers tendered his resignation citing personal reasons.

On its part, IndiGo's Board of Directors thanked Elbers for his contribution and service to the organisation and wished him well in his future endeavours.

Following Elbers' resignation, IndiGo Managing Director and Co-founder Rahul Bhatia will assume interim management of the airline

until a new CEO is appointed.

The company stated that the process of identifying a new leader is expected to conclude shortly.

In an internal communication to employees, Bhatia said the events of last December were unacceptable and had placed an undeserved burden on both customers and staff.

He acknowledged that frontline teams bore the weight of these challenges through for no fault of their own and expressed gratitude for the "sleepless nights"

spent by colleagues to restore operational integrity, describing the team's resilience as the heart and spirit of the airline.

Meanwhile, Vikram Singh Mehta, Chairman of the Board of IndiGo, said Bhatia's return to operational leadership would help strengthen the company's culture and reinforce operational excellence.

EXCEPTIONAL SERVICE

"Rahul returns to assume management of the affairs of the airline to strengthen the company's culture, reinforce operational excellence and deepen its commitment to delivering exceptional service of care, reliability and professionalism to its customers," Mehta said.

Bhatia said he felt a deep sense of personal commitment and responsibility towards the airline and its stakeholders after having founded and nurtured IndiGo for more than two decades.

Formulate vaccine compensation policy: SC to govt

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed the Centre to frame a no-fault compensation policy for serious adverse events following the Covid-19 vaccination.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta said the existing mechanism for monitoring adverse events following immunisation shall continue.

"No separate court-appointed expert body is considered necessary in view of the existing mechanism for scientific assessment of adverse events following immunisation," Justice Nath said while pronouncing the verdict.

The Bench clarified that its judgment shall not preclude any person from pursuing such other remedies as may be available in law. "Equally, the formulation of the no-fault framework shall not be construed as an admission of liability or fault on the part of the Union of India or any other authority," it said.

Madurai Airport gets international status

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The Centre on Tuesday declared Madurai airport in Tamil Nadu as an international airport. The announcement comes on the eve of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Tamil Nadu to participate in an NDA rally in Tiruchirappalli on Wednesday.

The Union Cabinet, chaired by the Prime Minister, approved the declaration of Madurai airport as an international airport.

Elevating Madurai airport to international status would enhance regional connectivity, promote trade and drive economic development in the region. The airport's potential to attract international pilgrims and businesses aligns with the city's historical prominence, according to an official release.

CRUCIAL GATEWAY

Madurai airport is one of the oldest airports in the State. It serves as a crucial gateway to southern Tamil Nadu and plays a pivotal role in promoting tourism and pilgrimage, contributing to the region's overall growth.

Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the three largest cities in Tamil Nadu are Chennai, Coimbatore and Madurai, and people have long aspired to have an international airport in Madurai.

"Keeping Madurai's aspirations in mind, Prime Minister Narendra Modi took the



A view of the Madurai Airport

decision in the Union Cabinet to approve Madurai airport as an international airport. This will bring a major change in the development of Madurai and Tamil Nadu," he said.

P Muthu Kumar, Airport Director, Madurai airport, said the airstrip had been operational since 1942, when it was used to transport newspapers from Chennai. The airport was operationalised as a civil airport in 1952 and began commercial operations in 1957.

MORE CHOICES

The international status means more number of Customs and Immigration personnel will be deployed and the facility will attract international airlines to operate with more choices to the travelling public, he told *businessline*. In 2011, the airport was declared a Customs airport, enabling international operations. The first international flight from Madurai took off to Sri Lanka in September 2012.

At present, Madurai has 242 scheduled aircraft movements a week and is connected to cities such as Chennai, Mumbai, New Delhi, Hyderabad and Bengaluru. On the international front, the airport has direct flights to Colombo, Dubai and Abu Dhabi. The Airports Authority of India (AAI) also commenced 24-hour operations at Madurai airport from October 1, 2024, he said.

In 2024-25, the airport handled 13,513 aircraft movements and 1.39 million passengers, including 1.16 million domestic passengers and 0.23 million international passengers.

With a runway length of 2,285 m, suitable for A-321 type aircraft, Madurai airport offers airside infrastructure that includes 12 parking bays and a CAT-I Instrument Landing System (ILS).

The airport is also equipped with international cargo facilities, Customs, immigration, Airport Health Organisation and plant quarantine services.

Coming soon, AI-powered *Kamba Ramayanam*

Animated movie reimagines the epic as 75th anniversary tribute to Chinmaya Mission

N Venkateswaran
Chennai

Kamba Ramayanam will soon return to the screens in a live-action AI animation *avatar*. Discussions for the movie, being made by Chennai-based Muonium AI Venture Studio, started only in December, but it is already in its post-production stage. It is expected to be ready for release by this month-end, showing how AI can speed up things considerably.

The initial plan is to release it in Tamil, Hindi and English, and other languages could be considered later.

The movie is inspired by the iconic 1980s stage production by Chinmaya Yuva Kendra, Madras, for which the music was composed by the legendary KV Mahadevan.

The songs performed by SP Balasubrahmanyam and Vani Jayaram will be retained in the movie. Swami



MIGHTY FLIGHT. A scene from *Kamba Ramayanam* in which Hanuman flies over Sri Lanka

Mitrananda, mentor and convener, Chinmaya Mission, Chennai and North-east, and National Advisor, All India Chinmaya Yuva Kendra, said: "It was Swami Chinmayananda who championed *Kamba Ramayanam* through theatre in the 1980s, an initiative that saw performances staged globally for decades. In honour of the 75th anniversary of Chinmaya Mission, the Chinmaya Yuva Kendra is bringing the film to screens using cutting-edge artificial intelligence, blending ancient wisdom with modern technology." The project started off as an AI movie, but

the team soon discovered that the AI engines, which were trained on certain sets of foreign video or content, could not effectively portray the emotions they wanted.

MOTION CAPTURE

"No AI model we tried could generate, for example, the *navarasas* that a trained dancer, be it in *bharatanatyam* or *kuchipudi* or *kathak*, could easily do. So, we decided to try live motion capture on a green screen and then use it in the film. All of this was done by volunteers, so we had students, engineers, a chartered ac-

countant... some 30 actors, all part-time, helping us portray different characters," Senthil Nayagam, General Partner at Muonium, told *businessline*.

On the advantages of using AI, he said: "After we generate a video, if someone is not happy with it, for example, with the jewels or costumes worn by Rama or Sita or the background scenery, we can rework it immediately, something that would have been very costly if you were doing it as a regular film. In fact, our budget of ₹1 crore would be less than the costume budget of a big budget movie such as *Baahubali*."

"We are exploring what the future of Indian cinema can look like without losing the soul of its past," sums up Nayagam.



25 Years of IDBI Trusteeship Services Limited – Strengthening Trust in India's Financial Markets

Leaders from India's Banking, Insurance and Financial sectors came together to commemorate 25 years of IDBI Trusteeship Services Limited (ITSL) — a milestone that reflects the institution's enduring contribution to India's capital markets and investor protection framework.

Present on the occasion were Shri. H.K. Panda (Independent Director - ITSL), Shri. Jayakumar S. Pillai (DMD - IDBI Bank & Chairman - ITSL), Shri. Rakesh Sharma (MD & CEO - IDBI Bank), Shri. R. Doraiswamy (CEO & MD - LIC of India), Shri. Pradeep K. Malhotra (MD & CEO - ITSL), Shri. Balkrishna Variar (CFO - GIC Re & Director - ITSL) and Dr. Kumar Neel Lohit (ED - IDBI Bank & Director - ITSL)

On this occasion, Shri. R. Doraiswamy (CEO & MD – LIC of India) and Shri. Rakesh Sharma (MD & CEO – IDBI Bank), jointly launched the new website of IDBI Trusteeship Services Limited (www.idbitrustee.com), marking another step in the company's commitment to enhancing transparency, accessibility and digital engagement with stakeholders; rededicating to investor services.



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